

Tamrack

New Employee Orientation Program Evaluation



OPWL 530 Evaluation
Boise State University
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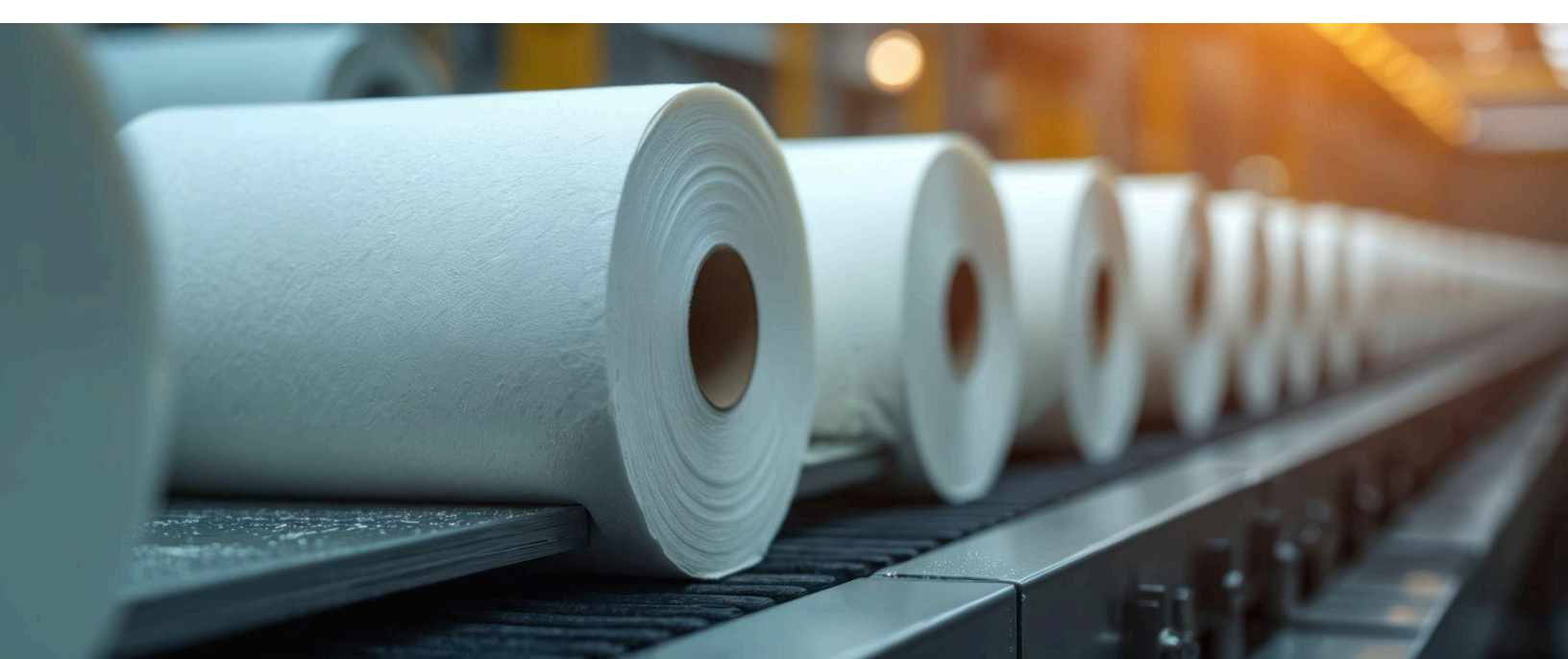
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Background

Tamrack, Inc. is a cleaning supply company serving hospitals and nursing homes with more than 200 employees in five states. In 2020, the company's Learning and Performance Solutions (LPS) department revised its New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program for virtual delivery. Since then, the program has undergone several revisions, but no formal program evaluation has been conducted.

At the request of the Director of Learning and Performance Solutions (Gill Gibson), the evaluation team conducted a formative, goal-based evaluation of the NEO program. The evaluation scope was limited to the structured first week onboarding experience. Pre-boarding activities and the informal one-month integration period were excluded.

The evaluation was designed to assess two dimensions identified in collaboration with the client and mapped to the program logic model: (1) "Feeling Welcomed" - whether new hires feel welcomed and integrated into Tamrack's culture and values, and (2) "Role Readiness" - whether new hires are prepared to begin learning their roles with their managers and teams.

Evaluation Methodology

The evaluation team collected qualitative and quantitative data from two stakeholder groups using four instruments:

- Participant survey (n=27): self-administered, anonymous, web-based
- Manager survey (n=14): self-administered, anonymous, web-based
- Participant interviews (n=4): voluntary, semi-structured, via video conference
- Manager interviews (n=3): voluntary, semi-structured, via video conference

Quantitative survey items used a 5-point Likert rating scale: (1) Strongly Disagree, (2) Somewhat Disagree, (3) Neither Agree nor Disagree, (4) Somewhat Agree, (5) Strongly Agree. Percentage summaries are reported as % Agree (score of 4-5), % Neutral (score of 3), and % Disagree (score of 1-2).

Open-ended survey responses and interview transcripts were coded by theme and sentiment using a codebook developed by the evaluation team.

For each dimension, the evaluation team applied rubrics to assign one of four ratings to the data source: Exceeds Expectations, Met Expectations, Improvement Needed, or Serious Problems. Source-level ratings were then triangulated (compared) at the dimensional level using the triangulation rubrics found in Appendix C.

Evaluation Results

Both dimensions were rated Met Expectations based on the triangulated findings.

“Feeling Welcomed” Evaluation Results

The “Feeling Welcomed” dimension showed strong quantitative results in all data sources. Participant survey responses were especially high, with a composite mean of 4.81 out of 5 and no respondent selecting Strongly or Somewhat Disagree on any welcome-related items. First-week engagement was high as well: 100% of new hires reported meeting with their manager, 92.6% met with their team, and 77.8% met with an assigned mentor. The participant survey rated Exceeds Expectations.

Interviews and open-ended survey responses told a different story. Participants described the orientation as impersonal and reported limited connection outside their immediate team. The survey scores were high, but the welcome experience was uneven. The interviews both rated Met Expectations.

Because the triangulation rubric requires both sources to be rated Exceeds Expectations, the overall rating for this dimension was determined to be Met Expectations.

“Role Readiness” Evaluation Results

The “Role Readiness” dimension also showed strong quantitative performance, with manager survey ratings at 4.68 out of 5, and no Strongly Disagree or Somewhat Disagree options selected on any items. Therefore, the manager survey was rated as Exceeds Expectations for the “Role Readiness” dimension.

However, NEO participants rated their own role readiness slightly lower than managers, with a composite participant survey mean of 4.55 out of 5. Most items scored above 4.4, with access to tools and systems highest at 4.96. Self-paced learning was the weakest item (mean 3.63) and the only item in either dimension where respondents selected Strongly Disagree or Somewhat Disagree. Among the participant survey items, self-paced learning showed the highest association with the overall readiness ($r=0.251$, $n=27$), though with a sample size this small, the correlation is still weak. The participant survey rated Met Expectations for the “Role Readiness” dimension.

Both manager and participant interviews rated this dimension Met Expectations, citing gaps in department-specific systems, benefits knowledge, on-the-job training, content relevance, and post-orientation structure.

Table 1 summarizes each data source's rating, the triangulated dimension rating, and the importance weighting of each dimension.

Table 1. Triangulated Dimensional Scoring

Dimension	Source Ratings	Triangulated Rating	Importance Weighting
Feeling Welcomed	● Participant survey: Exceeds ● Participant Interview: Met	Met Expectations	Critical
Role Readiness	● Manager survey: Exceeds ● Participant survey: Met ● Manager interview: Met ● Participant interview: Met	Met Expectations	Critical

Conclusions

The NEO program is performing well against its two primary outcomes. New hires report feeling welcome and connected to Tamrack's culture, and managers confirm that new hires demonstrate baseline readiness to begin learning their roles.

The program's clearest strength is cultural and relational onboarding. Manager engagement in the first week is universal, team engagement is near universal, and the welcome composite score is 4.81 out of 5 with no respondent selecting Strongly or Somewhat Disagree. The Day 1 synchronous orientation, values messaging, and team-level introductions are consistently cited as effective.

The clearest area for improvement is the self-paced learning experience. It scored the lowest of any item, was the only one where respondents selected Strongly or Somewhat Disagree, and came up more than anything else in interviews with both participants and managers. Participants described content as too dense for the first week and insufficiently connected to their actual job tasks.

The evaluation team's recommendations, presented in full in Section 6.2, address three areas in priority order:

1. Restructure the self-paced learning experience. Spread content over two to four weeks instead of compressing it into week one. Tailor modules to different roles, and replace some of the passive reading with short exercises based on realistic job tasks.
2. Make mentor meetings more consistent. Not every new hire is getting the same experience, so set a few required check-ins during the first two weeks with simple guidance on what to cover.

3. Help new hires connect outside their own team. The team-level welcome is strong, but new hires described limited connection to the rest of the organization. Adding cross-team introductions or a peer cohort would close that gap.

The evaluation scope was limited to the structured first-week experience, but the data pointed to root causes that cannot be fully resolved within the first week alone. These recommendations address problems identified within the evaluated scope but propose changes that extend into the wider onboarding timeline.

Limitations

The evaluation has several limitations. The sample size is small: 27 participants and 14 managers on the surveys, and interview samples of 4 and 3, respectively. The evaluation only covers the 2025 cohort. And participants who completed onboarding in January are drawing on much older memories than those who finished in December.

All semi-structured interviews were conducted by the client (LPS Director), not by the evaluation team. Respondents knew they were speaking with the person who runs the program, which may have led them to soften their feedback. The interview and survey findings were generally in line with each other, which partially offsets this risk, but both data sources may reflect a degree of social desirability bias.

The HR Director was unavailable throughout the evaluation period. The LPS Director was the sole upstream stakeholder and provided program context and organizational priorities, which should be considered when interpreting findings related to program design intent.

The evaluation team is confident in the overall dimensional findings. However, the sample size is too small to support reliable comparisons of different departments or quarters. Any patterns observed may suggest areas worth watching, but should not be treated as definitive findings.

1. BACKGROUND

Tamrack, Inc. is a cleaning supply company that serves hospitals and nursing homes. Founded in 2018 as a three-person startup in Boise, Idaho, the company has grown rapidly into a national corporation with more than 200 employees and branches in five states. Because Tamrack operates within healthcare environments, regulatory compliance and chemical handling are critical components of employee preparedness.

As Tamrack expanded from a regional company to a national one, delivering the same onboarding experience to employees in five states got harder. In 2020, driven by the COVID-19 pandemic, the company's Learning and Performance Solutions (LPS) department revised its New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program to be delivered entirely online. The shift to virtual delivery was retained after the pandemic because it reduced costs and supported the company's growing remote workforce. Although some branches still conduct onsite onboarding, Tamrack plans to transition to offering the program exclusively online within the next year. The program is company-wide and not role-differentiated; all new hires, regardless of position, complete the same orientation experience. The program serves approximately 30 new hires annually, with onboarding delivered monthly on each new hire's first day.

Since moving to a fully online format in 2020, the NEO program has been revised several times to improve its effectiveness. But these revisions relied on informal feedback. No formal program evaluation has been conducted. Meanwhile, the Human Resources department has identified employee turnover as an organizational priority and wants to understand whether current programs like NEO are supporting employee readiness and retention goals.

The evaluation team responded to a request from the Director of Learning and Performance Solutions (the Client) to conduct a formal evaluation of the online NEO program. For the purposes of this evaluation, the scope was limited to the structured first-week onboarding experience.

2. PROGRAM AND STAKEHOLDERS

2.1. New Employee Onboarding Program

Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program is a company-wide orientation designed to provide all new hires with a uniform introduction to the organization, regardless of role or location. The program is not role-differentiated; job-specific training is handled separately by each employee's direct manager after the onboarding period ends. The NEO program serves approximately 30 new hires annually, with training conducted monthly on each new hire's first day.

The current program consists of a structured first week followed by a less formal one-month integration period. The structured first week, which is the focus of this evaluation, is outlined in Table 2.

Table 2. New Hire Onboarding Program Schedule

Training Day	Topic	Modality	Duration
Day 1	Orientation and department introductions • Virtual welcome meeting with HR • Overview of company policies and procedures • Systems and tools introduction • Department introductions • CEO presentation on company culture and values	Instructor-led, virtual synchronous	9am - 4pm
Day 2 & 3	Compliance training Job-Specific Training Soft Skills Training	Self-paced, online	5-6 hours each
	Mentor meet & greet	Virtual or in person, Informal	Brief

On the first day, new hires attend a live virtual session during which representatives from Human Resources and Information Technology present key information on company policies, procedures, and expectations (see Appendix A.1 for the Day 1 schedule). The Chief Executive Officer also participates, delivering a presentation on organizational culture, values, and fostering what the organization describes as a family-like work environment. The remainder of the first week consists of required self-paced eLearning modules (see Appendix A.2), which new hires complete independently through the organization's learning management system. All modules must be completed by the end of the week, but the order of completion is left up to them.

During the first week, each new hire is also introduced to an assigned mentor through an informal meet-and-greet. The mentor component is largely unstructured. Mentors receive a brief orientation to the role, but there is no formal guide or structured set of topics for mentors to cover with their mentees. The organization has considered adding more structure but has not yet done so due to limited team capacity.

At the end of the one-month onboarding period, new hires complete a post-orientation feedback survey (see Appendix A.3). This is the organization's only existing feedback mechanism for the NEO program.

Through communication with the client, the evaluation team helped develop a program logic model for the NEO program. Table 3 presents the program logic model, outlining the resources, activities, outputs, outcomes, and intended impact of the program.

Table 3. New Employee Onboarding Program Logic Model

Resources	Activities	Outputs	Outcomes	Impact
What resources should be used to run the program?	What activities should be performed to run the program?	What products should be produced to support the intended outcomes?	What changes in the stakeholders should be made in the next 1 month (short-term) or 3 years (long-term)?	What changes in the organization and its society are expected in 1-3 years due to the outcomes?
• Video conference for synchronous sessions • Learning Management System (LMS) • Learning Performance Solutions staff and Instructional Designers • Input from HR Director • Organizational Documentation: ○ Employee handbook ○ Org chart ○ HR documentation and policies ○ Compliance policies ○ Workplace safety regulations ○ Data privacy and security policies ○ Job specific reference materials	• Create program documentation: ○ Onboarding Checklist ○ Welcome emails • Obtain organizational documentation • Develop or update synchronous presentations • Design and develop or update asynchronous training ○ Compliance ○ Soft Skills ○ Job-specific training • Upload asynchronous training to the LMS • Schedule presenters	• All new employees attend the program per month • All new employees complete the training • All new employees achieve minimum 80% assessment score • All new employees complete HR forms accurately and on time • All new employees set up workstation, VPN, and log into critical systems • All new employees meet with: ○ Assigned mentor ○ Manager ○ Team	Short Term • New employees feel prepared to work with mentor, manager, and team • New employees feel welcomed into Tamrack company culture, values, and norms • Employees are aware of company values • Employees follow company policies, regulations, and IT policies Longer Term • Employees feel confidence in performing basic to advanced job functions	• Improved new hire readiness • Stronger connection to managers, mentors, and team • Reduced on-the-job errors • Sustained organizational culture of compassion, respect, and family • Maintain a safe and healthy workplace • Reduced legal and security incidents • Maintain compliance and legal standing • Ensure data security and confidentiality • Prevent bribery and corruption • Reduced employee turnover (3+ years)

○ Soft skills requirements ○ Tamrack company values and goals information ● Onboarding portal ● Orientation Feedback Survey ● Personnel ○ CEO or Senior Exec ○ HR Director ○ HR Representative ○ IT Support ○ Mentor ○ Manager ○ Training and Development Coordinator ○ Health and Safety Officer ● Trainees	● Select and assign mentors ● Conduct synchronous training session ● Enroll new employees in self-paced training ● Track training completions and assessment scores ● Create and send post-program survey	● All new employees respond to the feedback survey	● Employees are confident navigating proprietary software and internal tools on-the-job ● Employees apply active listening and conflict resolution techniques ● Employees understand their safety responsibilities when handling hazardous materials and know where to go with questions	
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2.2. Stakeholders

There are three categories of stakeholders associated with Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program: upstream stakeholders, downstream direct impactees, and downstream indirect impactees.

Upstream Stakeholders

Upstream stakeholders are individuals involved in the decision-making, design, development, implementation, or maintenance of the first-week onboarding program (Chyung, 2019). It is unclear who originally led the design and implementation of the NEO program prior to its 2020 revision.

The key upstream stakeholders include:

- Gill Gibson, Director of Learning and Performance Solutions (LPS)
 - Serves as the client for this evaluation and oversees onboarding implementation and coordination.
- Bill Berg, Human Resources Director
 - Provides direction regarding onboarding content and organizational policy coverage. He is currently unavailable due to paternity leave.
- Two Instructional Designers (LPS Team)
 - Designed and developed the self-paced eLearning modules and coordinated virtual orientation materials.
- Sarah Smith, Chief Executive Officer
 - Delivers the Day 1 presentation on organizational culture and values.
- HR and IT Representatives
 - Present during the synchronous Day 1 orientation and provide support for onboarding logistics and LMS access.

The upstream stakeholder group involved in onboarding delivery is small, consisting of approximately six to eight individuals. The LPS team that manages the program on an ongoing basis consists of three members: Gill Gibson and two instructional designers.

Downstream Direct Impactees

Direct impactees are individuals who participate in the first-week onboarding program. These are new employees hired by Tamrack, approximately 30 per year for all departments and roles. These individuals are directly impacted by:

- The quality and clarity of the orientation
- The usability and instructional effectiveness of training modules
- The relevance of compliance, job-specific, and soft skills training
- The tone set for organizational culture and expectations

Downstream Indirect Impactees

Indirect impactees are individuals or groups affected by the outcomes of the onboarding program, even though they do not directly participate in it.

- Direct Supervisors and Managers of New Hires
 - In 2025: 24 managers in branches.
 - Managers assume responsibility for job-specific training once the new hire onboarding ends. The level of preparedness, policy awareness, and role clarity of new employees following onboarding directly affects the time and effort managers must spend to correct misunderstandings or reteach foundational content.
- Mentors
 - In 2025: 2 employees in 5 branches.
 - Mentors are paired with new hires during the first week. The quality of onboarding indirectly impacts the level of clarification and reinforcement mentors must provide.
- Current Employees and Team Members
 - Estimated: Approximately 160+ non-manager employees in 5 branches.
 - Colleagues are affected by how quickly new hires become productive and integrated into team workflows. Poor onboarding may increase the workload on existing staff.
- Customers
 - The quality of employee role readiness and values influences the customer's trust in the company.

3. EVALUATION METHODOLOGY

3.1. Evaluation Purpose and Type

The evaluation serves the Human Resources Director, the Director of Learning and Performance Solutions, and the LPS instructional design team, who will use the findings to identify strengths and areas for improvement in the first-week onboarding program and to inform future program revisions.

Because these stakeholders plan to use the findings to improve the program, this is a formative, back-end evaluation conducted after program implementation. The evaluation is goal-based, assessing the program against its stated objectives. The evaluation team also incorporated a goal-free approach to identify any unexpected effects (positive or negative) resulting from the recent change to virtual delivery and subsequent revisions.

3.2. Dimensions, Evaluation Questions, and Importance Weighting

Through initial communication with the client (Gill Gibson) and review of the program logic model (see Table 3), the evaluation team developed a preliminary list of program dimensions to investigate. The evaluation team proposed the dimensions to the client, who confirmed them as priorities based on input from the CEO and HR Director's organizational goals.

Once the dimensions were established, the evaluation team discussed with the client how they intended to use the findings. The client, representing the interests of both the HR Director and CEO, expressed that both dimensions are equally important to organizational success. Therefore, the evaluation team assigned equal importance weighting (IW) to both dimensions. Results are shown below (also see the first column of Appendix C):

1. **Feeling Welcomed:** How effectively does the orientation program incorporate and present company culture and values? How well does the orientation program incorporate materials, activities, and messaging that support a welcoming environment?
 - **PLM:** Activities, Outcomes
 - **Importance Weighting:** Critical (1)
2. **Role Readiness:** How well does orientation prepare employees to work with their manager, mentor, and team to learn their role responsibilities? How effective are the orientation materials and activities in enabling new employees to start learning their role with their manager, mentor, and team?
 - **PLM:** Activities, Outcomes
 - **Importance Weighting:** Critical (1)

Both dimensions correspond to short-term outcomes in the program logic model and reflect the organization's priorities related to cultural integration and role readiness.

3.3. Data Collection Procedure and Methods

The evaluation team collected data from two stakeholder groups using four instruments. Comparing findings from different sources and methods helped the team check whether the results held up.

Surveys

- Two structured, self-administered, anonymous web-based survey questionnaires were developed and administered: one to all NEO participants who completed the program between January and December 2025 (n = 27), and one to all managers of those employees (n = 14).
- Surveys allowed the evaluation team to collect both quantitative and qualitative self-reported data from the full population of both stakeholder groups. But surveys can leave out important details, are vulnerable to low response rates, and rely on self-assessment.

Interviews

- To offset the limitations of survey data, the evaluation team conducted voluntary, semi-structured, one-on-one video conference interviews (approximately 30 minutes each) with two groups: managers from applicable departments (n = 3, selected via purposive sampling) and recent NEO participants (n = 4, selected via purposive sampling).
- Interviews gave the team a closer look at what knowledge gaps kept coming up, what the first week actually felt like for new hires, and which parts of the program worked better live versus self-paced.

The detailed data collection methods table, including the rationale for comparing findings across different sources, is presented in Appendix C. A summary of instruments by dimension is provided in Table 4.

Table 4. Summary of Instruments by Dimension

Data Collection Instrument:	Dimension 1: “Role Readiness”	Dimension 2: “Feeling Welcomed”
Web-based survey with employees	X	X
Web-based survey with managers	X	
Semi-structured, one-on-one interviews with managers	X	
Semi-structured one-on-one interviews with recent NEO completers	X	X
Qualitative Feedback Codebook	X	X

In summary, the following instruments were developed: two structured online survey questionnaires (NEO participants, managers), two survey invitation emails (managers, recent NEO participants), two semi-structured interview instruments (managers, recent NEO participants), two interview solicitation emails, and two informed consent forms.

Quantitative survey items used a 5-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree). Interview data were coded by theme and sentiment using the codebook developed by the evaluation team (see Appendix E). Findings from each data source were assessed against a four-level rubric scale (Serious Problems, Improvement Needed, Met Expectations, Exceeds Expectations), then compared at the dimensional level using the rubrics defined in Appendix C.

4. FEASIBILITY AND RISK FACTORS

4.1 Feasibility

The evaluation team assessed the feasibility of completing this evaluation using five factors: maturity, scope, ethical concerns, resources, and stakeholder support.

The virtual format of the NEO program has been in place since 2020, with recurring monthly delivery cycles over approximately five years. This level of maturity, combined with existing survey data and training materials, provided a sufficient foundation for meaningful evaluation. The scope is limited to the structured first week of onboarding, with pre-boarding activities and the informal one-month integration period excluded. The client demonstrated strong support for the evaluation, providing access to onboarding materials, training outlines, and prior survey data. No significant ethical concerns were identified, though the evaluation team monitored the reliance on a single upstream stakeholder as the primary point of contact. No additional financial costs were imposed on the client organization, and all interactions occurred via email or video conferencing (full details of the feasibility assessment is presented in Appendix B).

The team concluded that the evaluation was feasible to implement and complete within the available timeframe. Table 5 presents the evaluation project schedule.

Table 5. Evaluation Project Schedule

Task	Delivery Date
Kickoff meeting with client The evaluation team met with the client to discuss the NEO program, identify stakeholders, clarify the purpose of the evaluation, and assess project feasibility and scope.	January 20, 2026
Develop program logic model, determine dimensions/importance weighting The evaluation team worked with the client to develop a program logic model for the NEO program and to identify the evaluation dimensions and their importance weighting.	February 15, 2026
Determine data collection methods The evaluation team identified feasible data collection methods for each dimension and developed a triangulation strategy using surveys and semi-structured interviews with two stakeholder groups.	February 22, 2026
Develop and submit evaluation proposal The evaluation team prepared a written evaluation proposal documenting the background, program description, methodology, and feasibility assessment, and submitted it to the client for review and approval.	March 1, 2026

Develop data collection instruments and obtain approval The evaluation team developed all required materials to be used to collect data and submitted them to the stakeholders for approval.	March 11, 2026
Collect data With the stakeholders' support (e.g., granting access to employees and extant data, encouraging employees to participate in the study), the evaluation team collected data.	March 15, 2026
Analyze data with rubrics The evaluation team worked with the stakeholders to develop rubrics and analyze collected data against the rubrics.	March 29, 2026
Synthesize and draw conclusions The evaluation team combined dimensional results, drew evidence-based conclusions, and developed recommendations.	April 8, 2026
Submit final evaluation report The evaluation team wrote an evaluation final report and submitted it to the stakeholders via e-mail. The team recommends arranging a meeting with the stakeholders for a presentation and Q&A.	May 1, 2026

4.2 Risk Factors

The evaluation team identified and monitored the following risk factors throughout the project:

- **Limited access to upstream stakeholders.** The HR Director was unavailable for the entire evaluation period, which left the LPS Director as the only upstream contact. The team relied more heavily on participant and manager data to compensate and documented this gap in the limitations section (7.2).
- **Limited access to LMS data.** The team did not have direct access to the learning management system, so it requested completion reports from the client and included targeted survey and interview questions about the LMS experience.
- **Scope creep.** Onboarding at Tamrack extends past the first week, so there was potential pressure to expand the evaluation scope. The team maintained clear boundaries and required explicit approval for any scope changes.
- **Stakeholder participation rates.** Survey fatigue and scheduling conflicts reduced participation. The team worked to keep instruments short, used multiple data collection methods, communicated the value of participation, and coordinated with the client to schedule data collection during work hours.
- **Misalignment of evaluation expectations.** There was potential for differing expectations between HR and LPS regarding priorities. The team addressed this early by clarifying the evaluation's purpose and intended use with the client before work began.

- **Communication Constraints:** All communication was virtual, which increased the chance of delays or miscommunications. The team responded to stakeholder inquiries within 24 hours and when needed, asked for clarification.

Table 6 summarizes the risk assessment.

Table 6. Risk Assessment Matrix

Likelihood				
Damage to project	Minor	Moderate	Substantial	Detrimental
Unlikely		Misalignment of evaluation goals between HR Director and LPS Director		
Maybe	Communication constraints	Stakeholder participation rates	Scope creep; Upstream stakeholder availability	
Likely	Limited access to extant data (LMS)	HR Director not available		

The evaluation team's overall assessment was that the benefits of conducting a structured formative evaluation outweighed the identified risks. None of the risks ended up impacting the evaluation.

5. EVALUATION RESULTS

This section reports findings on the two dimensions the evaluation was designed to measure: “Role Readiness” and “Feeling Welcomed.” For each dimension, evidence is drawn from four data sources: a web-based participant survey (n=27), a web-based manager survey (n=14), semi-structured interviews with new hires (n=4), and semi-structured interviews with managers (n=3). Findings from each data source are presented below, followed by a rubric judgment for each source and a triangulated dimensional rating. Complete survey response data are presented in Appendix F (participants) and Appendix G (managers).

The charts below provide a cross-dimensional overview of the findings before the detailed analysis by dimension.

Chart 1 presents the mean Likert scores from the participant survey. “Feeling Welcomed” items (light blue) cluster at the top end of the scale, all with scores above 4.7. “Role Readiness” items (dark blue) sit close behind in the 4.4–5.0 range, with one clear outlier: self-paced learning content in red at 3.63. This is the only item falling below the 4-point “agreement” line.

Chart 1. Participant Survey Likert Means by Item (n=27)

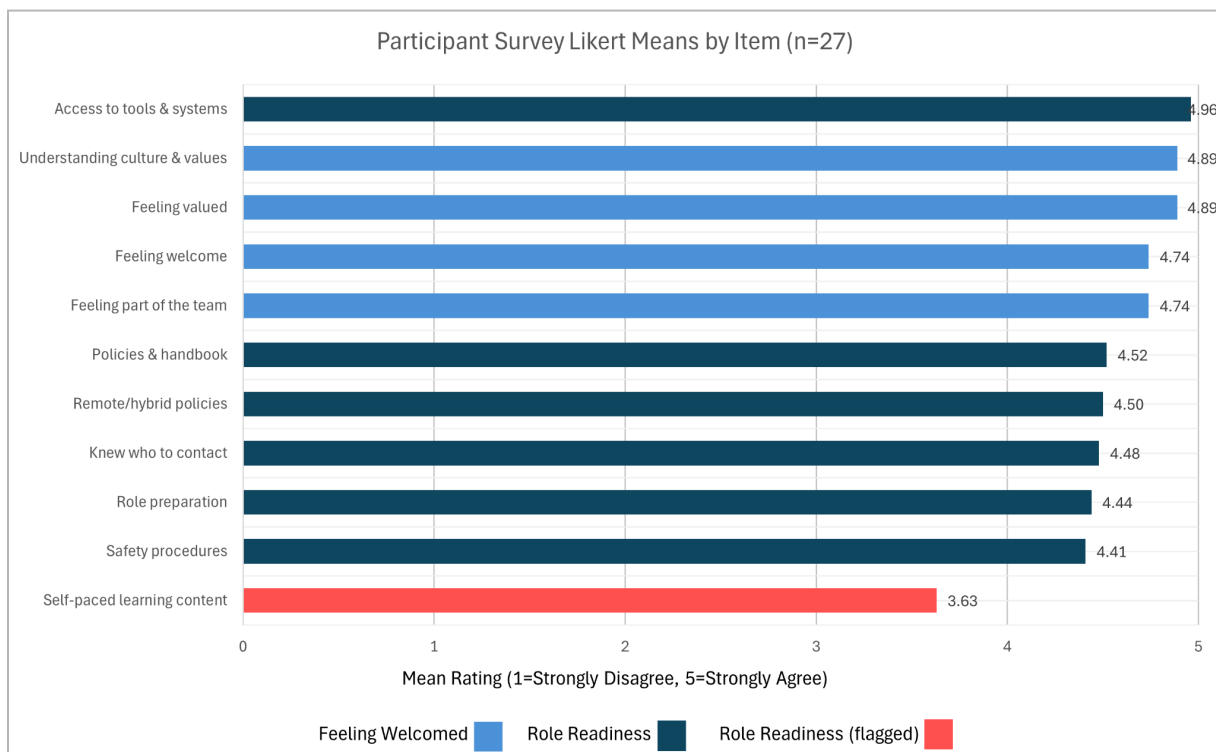


Chart 2 presents coded sentiment from semi-structured interviews. Regarding “Role Readiness,” participants’ interview excerpts were net positive, with 5 positive, 1 neutral, and 2 negative-coded quotes. Manager interview excerpts showed 2 positive, 16 neutral, and 4 negative coded quotes, with neutral commentary accounting for the largest share. The small Manager: “Feeling Welcomed” response

section (n=2) reflects that managers were not asked as directly about the welcome dimension. Interview excerpt data coded by theme and sentiment are presented in Appendix H.

Chart 2. Interview Sentiment by Respondent and Theme

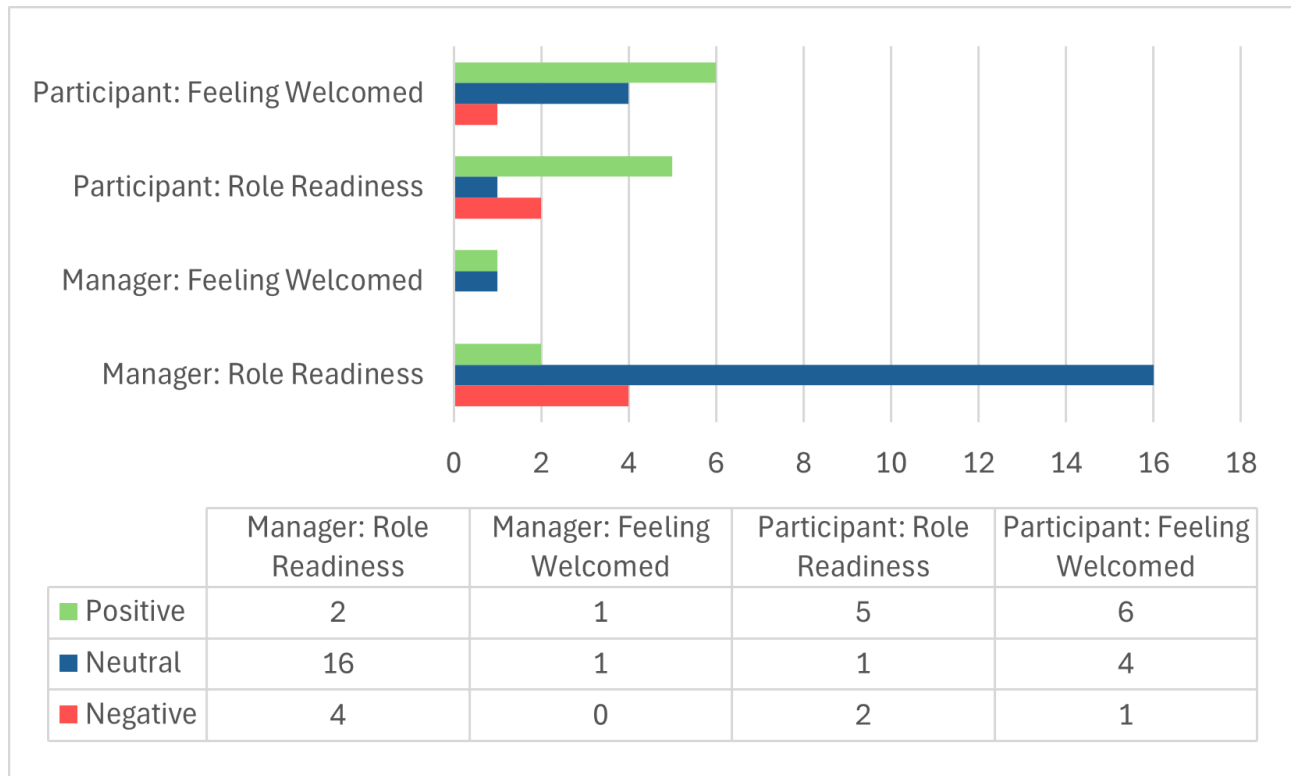


Chart 3 presents coded sentiment from open-ended survey responses. On “Role Readiness”, participant survey comments showed 3 positive, 4 neutral, and 3 negative coded quotes. Manager survey comments showed 7 positive, 2 neutral, and 2 negative coded quotes. Participant “Feeling Welcomed” commentary from surveys was more negative than positive, with a large neutral block (3 positive, 10 neutral, 8 negative).

Chart 3. Survey Sentiment by Respondent and Theme



A combined chart showing qualitative data from both sources and respondent group, dimension, and sentiment is available in Appendix I. In total, the evaluation team coded 85 qualitative excerpts in both dimensions: 27 positive, 38 neutral, and 20 negative. Instrument-specific counts used for rubric scoring are reported in Appendices I and J.

5.1. Dimension 1: Role Readiness

Survey Findings

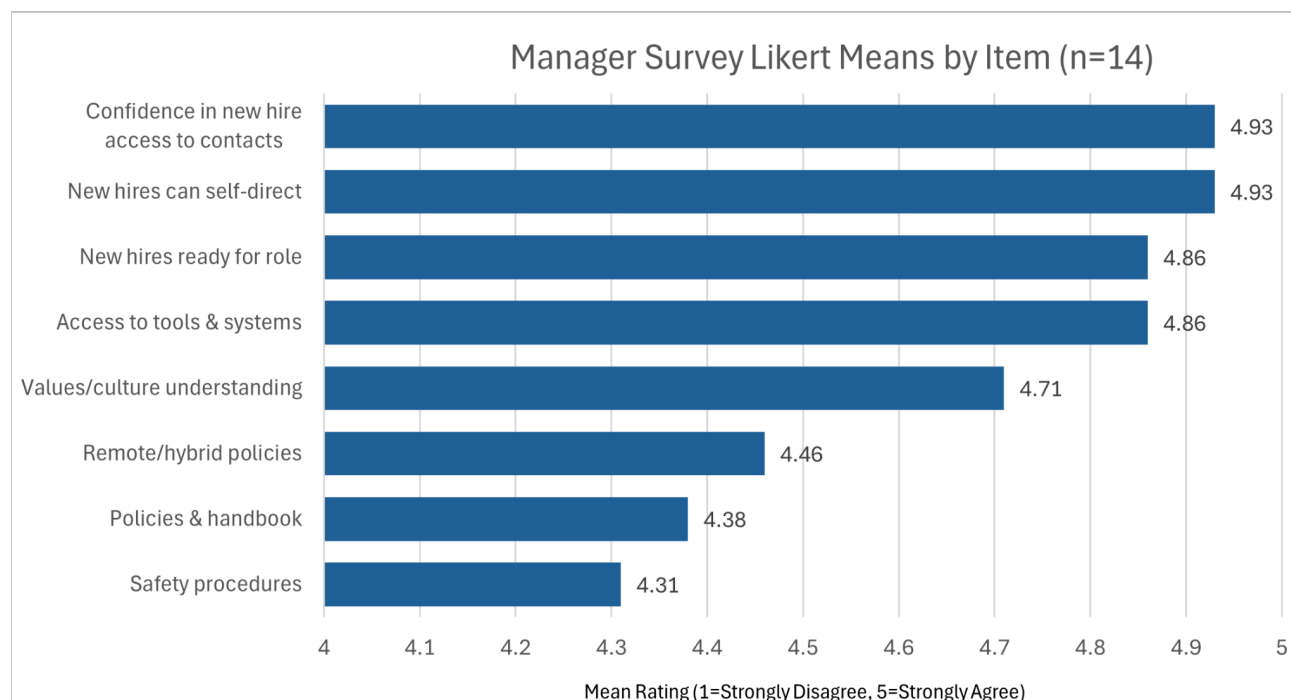
New hires rated themselves as ready for their roles (composite 4.55 out of 5, with 100% selecting Strongly or Somewhat Agree for the overall readiness item). Managers tended to agree, rating new-hire role readiness at 4.86 on the parallel manager item.

As shown in Chart 1, at the item level, participants rated access to tools and systems highest (4.96), followed by policies (4.52), remote/hybrid policies (4.50), understanding of key contacts (4.48), role preparation (4.44), and safety procedures (4.41). Self-paced learning (3.63) was the only item with any negative responses, with 22.2% of participants indicating disagreement that the self-paced training was “an effective way to learn the material.” Among the participant survey items, self-paced learning showed the strongest association with overall readiness rating ($r=0.251$, $n=27$). This is a fairly weak correlation given the small sample size and r -value, but it is consistent with the qualitative findings. Self-paced

learning is also the only item with Strongly or Somewhat Disagree responses, and the most frequently cited are for improvement in both participant and manager interviews.

Managers' item-level ratings told a similar story as depicted in Chart 4 below. Confidence in new-hire readiness, self-direction, and access to contacts all landed at 4.86–4.93, essentially at ceiling. The lower-rated manager items were content-focused (safety 4.31, policies 4.38, remote/hybrid expectations 4.46), corresponding to participants' rankings of the same topics. Where managers flagged gaps, they clustered on the asynchronous modules, specifically pace, depth, and role-specific relevance. A summary of this data can be found in Appendix J: Employee Role Readiness Survey Summary.

Chart 4. Manager Survey Likert Means by Item (n=14)



Interview Findings

Managers

The manager interviews echoed the survey findings. New hire preparedness after NEO scored high on the scaled item (4.33 out of 5), but managers in all three departments pointed to the same gap: department-specific systems, tools, and product knowledge are not covered, leaving that training to managers and team leads. Specific examples included assistance with logging information in department software, requesting IT support, and using the internal directory. One manager noted that on-the-job training uses significant department time, while another said location-specific work made the general orientation unnecessary for their team. The overall pattern is that managers see NEO as a general foundation rather than full role preparation.

NEO appears to give new hires a starting point for whom to ask for assistance, though benefits information appeared as a noticeable gap in employee understanding. One manager said their new hire knew where to find basic information and who to contact, but two managers in different departments reported employees having benefits questions that had to be referred to HR. Team leads and department contact lists were described as helpful resources.

Managers suggested including a supervisor checklist so post-onboarding expectations are clear, a 30-day check-in to catch gaps early, tighter coordination with HR, and more hands-on compliance training, especially on workplace safety.

Participants

Participants described a similar pattern. The orientation gave them a general foundation but the content often felt disconnected from their actual roles. Several wanted more applied, hands-on learning. Most knew who to go to when they had questions, and many reported learning on the job from managers, mentors, or teammates, but this support was informal rather than built into the program.

Feedback on the self-guided training was mostly negative. Participants described the eLearning as repetitive and too general. Several said it was hard to get through the modules while also adjusting to a new job. Some wanted shorter, more interactive formats. Mentoring experiences were uneven. Some participants had regular, helpful interactions with their mentors. Others met with their mentor once, or not at all. The difference appeared to depend on the individual pairing.

What is Working

In surveys and interviews, participants and managers identified the following strengths in “Role Readiness”: access to tools and systems is reliable and near-universal, new hires understand who to contact for different types of support, and the Day 1 synchronous session provides a clear overview of policies and expectations. Managers confirmed that new hires arrive with a general foundation sufficient to begin role-specific training.

Areas for Improvement

The self-paced modules are the clearest area for improvement. They received the lowest survey rating (3.63), were the only item with Strongly or Somewhat disagree responses, and were identified as a challenge in interview feedback from both participants and managers. Specific issues include content that is too general, too front-loaded, and not sufficiently connected to job tasks. Role-specific preparation is a secondary gap; the program prepares new hires at a company-wide level but does not bridge to department-level readiness.

Direct Quotes

- *“The only issue was finding time to complete all the eLearning while adjusting to my new workload. The eLearning modules were fine, but a little repetitive.” - Participant Interview*

- *“I'd add department-specific sessions or hands-on practice using our tools. It was fine overall, but the first few weeks felt a bit overwhelming with all of the systems to learn.” - Participant Interview*
- *“The compliance training needs to be more hands-on and practical. We have to review all of it here and provide examples so employees understand how important it is to our work handling chemicals and keeping the workplace safe.” - Manager Interview*

Rubric Ratings

As shown in Table 7, across all data sources, “Role Readiness” generally Met Expectations, often scoring near Exceeds. But qualitative feedback highlighted gaps in role-specific depth and hands-on application that prevented a higher overall rating.

Table 7. Role Readiness Rubric Score

Dimension	Instrument / Rubric	Per-source rating	Evidence summary
Role Readiness	1.1 Manager Survey (Q3–Q6, Q8–Q11)	Exceeds Expectations	Item means 4.31–4.93 (composite $\approx$ 4.68); no Strongly or Somewhat Disagree on any of the 8 items.
Role Readiness	1.2 Participant Survey (Q13–Q21)	Met Expectations	Composite role-readiness average 4.44; disqualified from Exceeds because the self-paced module item carried Strongly or Somewhat Disagree responses (22% disagree, mean 3.63). Qualitative themes confirm gaps.
Role Readiness	1.3 Manager Interview (Scaled Q2; Qualitative Q1, Q3–Q8)	Met Expectations	Scaled Q2 mean 4.33; qualitative comments indicate NEO generally prepared new hires with minor gaps (department-specific systems, benefits info, on-the-job training load). 4 negative versus 2 positive comments signal non-trivial gaps. Although the scaled item mean (4.33) meets the quantitative threshold for Exceeds Expectations, the rubric requires that qualitative comments also indicate adequate preparation with no more than minor gaps (see Appendix C). The volume of negative comments on department-specific systems, benefits knowledge, and on-the-job training load does not satisfy this condition, so the source rates Met Expectations.
Role Readiness	1.4 Participant Interview (Scaled Q8; Qualitative Q2, Q5, Q7–Q10)	Met Expectations	Scaled Q8 mean 4.25 (5, 4, 4, 4); qualitatively Met Expectations because participants described NEO as too general, needing more hands-on learning and role-specific content. The scaled item mean (4.25) meets the quantitative threshold for Exceeds

			Expectations, but the rubric requires qualitative comments that also indicate participants felt adequately prepared to begin working with their manager and team. Feedback that content was too general and lacked applied learning does not satisfy this condition.
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5.2. Dimension 2: Feeling Welcomed

Survey Findings

“Feeling Welcomed” is the stronger of the two dimensions. The composite score is 4.81 out of 5, and no respondent selected Strongly or Somewhat Disagree on any item. Culture fit (4.89) and sense of being valued (4.89) scored highest, followed by feeling welcomed (4.74) and feeling part of the team (4.74). Every respondent chose either Strongly or Somewhat Agree. Managers told a similar story, rating new hires’ understanding of culture and values at 4.71, again with 100% selecting either Strongly or Somewhat Agree.

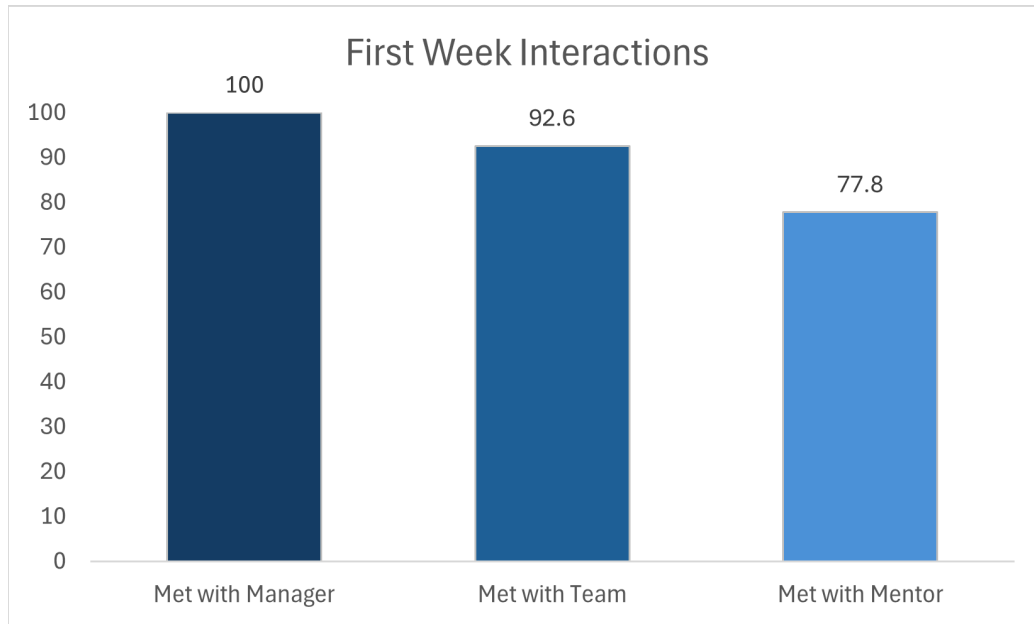
Table 8 shows the item-level means by respondent group.

Table 8. Feeling Welcomed Survey Summary

Respondent	Item	n	Mean	% Agree (4–5)	% Neutral (3)	% Disagree (1–2)
Participant	Feels welcomed	27	4.74	100	0	0
Participant	Part of the team	27	4.74	100	0	0
Participant	Valuable introduction	27	4.89	100	0	0
Manager	Culture & values	14	4.71	100	0	0
Participant	Culture & values	27	4.89	100	0	0

Chart 5 illustrates this from another angle. Every new hire reported meeting with their manager (92.6% specifically in week one), 92.6% met their team, and 77.8% met an assigned mentor. Manager engagement is the most reliable part of the welcome experience. The 22-point drop between manager/team contact (100% and 92.5%) and mentor contact (77.8%) is where the unevenness in this dimension comes from.

Chart 5. First-Week Interactions (Participant Self-Report)



Interview Findings

Managers

Manager interviews reinforced the survey findings. Managers described new hires as engaged, comfortable, and quickly connecting with peers.

Participants

Qualitative sentiment from participant interviews on welcome-related themes was more mixed than the Likert data alone would suggest: 9 Positive, 14 Neutral, and 9 Negative coded quotes (n=32) with positive and negative commentary almost evenly balanced. Positive themes clustered around manager attentiveness, team friendliness, and clarity of the first-day synchronous orientation. Negative themes clustered around inconsistent mentor assignment and variability in how connected new hires felt outside their immediate team.

What is Working

Three strengths came up in participant interviews and survey open-ended responses. Team-level welcome is the strongest signal. Activities like team introductions, team lunches, and one-on-one introductions with teammates in the first week were cited as the single strongest welcome moment. Values messaging is effective. Participants described the mission, values, and diversity and inclusion content as inspiring and pride-inducing. Team dynamics reinforce the welcome, with manager interviews noting that close-knit teams make the transition easier and participant interviews confirming it.

Areas for Improvement

The team identified three gaps in the interviews and open-ended survey questions. None appear in the quantitative data, but they are the reason the participant interview rubric is rated Met Expectations rather than Exceeds Expectations. First, orientation feels impersonal. Participants feel welcomed by their team but describe the orientation itself as generic, a pattern that may cause ceiling effects in survey items to mask a real experience gap. Second, connection outside the immediate team is limited. Participants describe a warm, team-level welcome but limited connection to the larger organization. Third, leader communication is a single-touchpoint event. A manager interview included a suggestion for new hires to hear directly from senior leaders about values and goals more than once during orientation.

Direct Quotes

- *“My manager and team members stopped by my desk to introduce themselves, and my mentor took me to lunch too. That helped me feel comfortable right away.”*
- *“I thought it was a good orientation to our culture and values.”*
- *“Having the team meetings the first week was really good, too. It let me know how the company values our teamwork.”*
- *“My team was very welcoming, but the orientation itself felt a bit impersonal.”*
- *“I didn't get to meet many people outside my immediate team.”*
- *“New employees would benefit from hearing directly from senior leaders about the company's values and long-term goals more frequently than just one time during the orientation.”*

Rubric Ratings

“Feeling Welcomed” exceeded expectations overall in survey data, but only met expectations when interviews were included. This shows that although rated highly on the survey, qualitative feedback provided more nuance that the orientation felt impersonal and didn’t fully build connection beyond immediate teams.

Table 9 provides a summary and explanation of each source’s score.

Table 9. *Feeling Welcomed Rubric Score*

Dimension	Instrument / Rubric	Per-source rating	Evidence summary
Feeling Welcomed	2.1 Participant Survey (Q8–Q11)	Exceeds Expectations	All four welcome items mean 4.74–4.89 (composite 4.81); zero Strongly or Somewhat Disagree responses.
Feeling Welcomed	2.2 Participant Interview (Scaled Q3;	Met Expectations	Scaled Q3 mean 4.25; qualitative data is mixed: strong team-level welcome, but orientation itself described as impersonal and organizational connection limited. The

	Qualitative Q2, Q4–Q6)		scaled item mean (4.25) meets the quantitative threshold for Exceeds Expectations, but the rubric requires that qualitative comments show that participants also felt the orientation effectively communicated culture and values and made them feel welcomed. Mixed qualitative sentiment, including descriptions of the orientation as impersonal and limited connection outside immediate team, does not satisfy this condition.
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5.3. Dimensional triangulation

As shown in Table 10, when results are triangulated for all dimensions and evaluation methods, both dimensions are rated “Met Expectations.”

Table 10. Dimensional triangulation

Dimension	Source ratings	Triangulated rating	Triangulation logic
Role Readiness	1.1 Exceeds; 1.2 Met; 1.3 Met; 1.4 Met	Met Expectations	Requires at least three of four sources at Exceeds for the dimension to rate Exceeds. Only one source (manager survey) reaches Exceeds, so the dimension rates Met. All four sources rate Met or higher and none rate Improvement Needed or Serious Problems.
Feeling Welcomed	2.1 Exceeds; 2.2 Met	Met Expectations	Requires both sources at Exceeds for the dimension to rate Exceeds. The participant interview rates Met (qualitative), so the dimension rates Met. Both sources rate Met or higher and neither rates Improvement Needed.

6. CONCLUSIONS

6.1. Overall Results

The NEO program is performing well against its two primary outcomes: “Feeling Welcomed” and “Role Readiness.” By triangulating survey data and interview insights from participants and managers, the evaluation team determined that both dimensions meet expectations. Table 11 summarizes the evaluation results. Dimension ratings were determined by rubrics presented in Appendix C.

Table 11. Evaluation Results

Dimension	Program Logic Model	Importance Weighting	Results
Feeling Welcomed	Activities, Outcomes	Critical	Meets Expectations
Role Readiness	Activities, Outcomes	Critical	Meets Expectations

New hires report a strong sense of welcome and connection to Tamrack’s culture, supported by high levels of early engagement with both managers and teams. “Role Readiness” outcomes indicate that new hires feel generally prepared to begin their roles, and managers corroborate that new hires demonstrate baseline technical readiness. The primary gap is in the self-paced learning experience, which received the lowest ratings and the only disagreement responses in either dimension.

Although the NEO program was generally perceived positively, the goal-free analysis showed several unintended effects. High survey ratings masked underlying issues such as cognitive overload, unclear relevance of content, and limited opportunities for meaningful social interaction. Additionally, the program’s flexible self-paced training structure was confusing rather than helpful, and gaps in role readiness were often compensated for by managers post-onboarding.

6.2. Recommendations

The NEO program should be maintained largely as designed, but three areas need changes. These are listed in priority order.

One note on scope: the evaluation focused on the first week, but some of the problems it uncovered (content volume, pacing, mentor timing) can’t be fixed within week one alone. Where evidence points beyond the first week, the recommendations follow it. Any changes to the broader onboarding timeline need to be planned and assessed separately.

1. Restructure the self-paced learning experience.

Self-paced learning scored 3.63 out of 5, the lowest item for both dimensions and the only item where respondents disagreed (22.2%). Managers and participants independently described the same problems in interviews: too much content, too general, too hard to complete alongside a new job in the first week.

Three changes would fix this.

The current timeline tries to compress all required modules into five days. Spreading them over two to four weeks would give new hires time to absorb the material and engage with it when it's actually relevant to their work. The modules are also identical for every role, which participants flagged as a limitation. Tagging content by role or creating a few role-specific pathways would let them focus on what applies to them. Finally, both groups described the modules as repetitive and passive. Trading some of the existing material for short exercises tied to realistic job tasks would give new hires something to do with what they're learning, not just read about it.

2. Make mentor meetings more consistent.

Manager engagement is strong: 100% of new hires met their manager, 92.6% in the first week. Mentor engagement is not. Only 77.8% reported meeting an assigned mentor, and interview data from both sides described the mentoring experience as inconsistent. Quality and frequency depended on the individual pairing.

The mentor program doesn't need an overhaul. The current setup, where mentors get a brief orientation and meet informally with new hires, works well when it happens. The problem is that it doesn't always happen. A small set of required touchpoints would fix this: an initial meeting in week one, a check-in in week two, and simple guidance on what to cover. Managers also suggested a 30-day check-in to catch gaps early, which would reinforce this without adding much effort.

3. Help new hires connect outside their immediate team.

The Feeling Welcome dimension rated the highest overall, but the interviews caught something the survey missed. New hires feel welcomed by their team, but several described limited connection to the rest of the organization. The orientation itself felt impersonal, and most people did not meet anyone outside their immediate group.

This matters because the survey asks about feeling welcomed and feeling like "part of the team," and new hires answered with their immediate team in mind. But the strong scores may be masking a weaker sense of belonging to Tamrack as a whole. A few small additions would help: cross-team introductions, a peer cohort for new hires starting in the same month, or more visibility from senior leaders beyond the Day 1 CEO presentation. The goal is to close the gap between feeling welcomed to feeling like part of the organization.

7. META-EVALUATION AND LIMITATIONS

7.1. Meta-Evaluation

To ensure the feasibility and accuracy of the evaluation throughout the 10-step process, the evaluation team conducted meta-evaluations at key phases. A meta-evaluation is an "evaluation of an evaluation," during which the team analyzes the ethics, usefulness, and feasibility of its own processes (Chyung, 2019). This allows the team to determine if the evaluation is being conducted in a way that is valuable

and trustworthy for the stakeholders. The evaluation team continuously assessed the quality and integrity of the evaluation process against the American Evaluation Association's Guiding Principles for Evaluators (American Evaluation Association, n.d.).

Systematic Inquiry

The evaluation followed Chyung's (2019) 10-step procedure and collected data from multiple sources (participant and manager surveys, participant and manager interviews) so that findings from one source could be checked against others (triangulated) before the team drew conclusions. When the team noticed during analysis that some survey questions may have pushed responses in a particular direction, it revised the qualitative coding approach to better capture what participants were actually saying. Small sample sizes and constraints in historical data were explicitly accounted for in the interpretation of results.

Competence

The evaluation team consists of developing-level practitioners with varying levels of prior experience in survey design, interview facilitation, qualitative and quantitative analysis, and rubric design. To address this, the team used established frameworks, incorporated peer review of all instruments and analysis, and operated under structured supervision by a university instructor with expertise and experience in evaluation methodology.

Integrity

The client recruited interview participants and conducted the interviews herself, which introduced a risk that respondents would hold back criticism. To offset this, the team made clear that survey responses were anonymous and that the evaluation was about the program, not about individual performance. This potential influence is acknowledged as a limitation.

Respect for People

All survey responses were anonymized, and identifying details were removed from interview excerpts. Before participating, respondents were told what the evaluation was for and how their feedback would be used, so that participation was genuinely informed and voluntary.

Common Good and Equity

The team achieved strong response rates for both participant and manager populations (27 of approximately 30 participants; 14 managers), helping to ensure representation within the available population. The team remained conscious of potential power dynamics and worked to minimize their impact on the data quality.

7.2. Limitations

Sample Size

27 participants and 14 managers completed surveys. The Interview samples (4 participants, 3 managers) are too small to stand on their own but help check what the survey data shows. The sample size is too small to draw reliable conclusions about differences between departments or quarters. Any patterns at that level may suggest areas worth watching, but should not be treated as firm findings.

Cross-sectional Design

The evaluation measured the 2025 cohort's experience at a single post-onboarding point. The evaluation team cannot draw conclusions about year-over-year trends or retention outcomes from this data alone. Prior survey instruments were not designed for comparison over time, so the findings are a snapshot, not a trend.

Recall Variability

While few respondents chose the "I don't know/remember" options, participants who completed onboarding earlier in 2025 may recall their experience differently from participants who completed it more recently. This variability may affect the quality of self-reported data.

Self-report Bias

Participants assessed their own readiness and welcome experience, which may be subject to social desirability effects. Manager triangulation partially offsets but does not eliminate this limitation.

Upstream Stakeholder Representation

The evaluation relied on a single upstream stakeholder (the LPS Director) as the primary source of program context and historical information. The HR Director was unavailable throughout the evaluation period. Therefore, the team's understanding of the program's original design intent comes from only one perspective.

Client Involvement in Data Collection

The client conducted all semi-structured interviews directly, introducing herself to respondents as the LPS Director. Although interview consent forms and opening scripts emphasized voluntary participation and anonymity, respondents may have moderated their feedback given the interviewer's authority over the program being evaluated. This risk is partially reduced by the consistency between interviews and surveys, as surveys were anonymous and self-administered. However, both data sources may reflect some social desirability bias.

7.3 Lessons Learned

Beyond the program findings, the evaluation process itself produced several lessons worth remembering for future work.

Survey Ceiling Scores

The “Feeling Welcomed” survey scores were near ceiling, but interview data told a more complicated story. Without the interviews, the evaluation would have missed the gap between team-level welcome and organization-level connection. For future evaluations, the team recommends always combining qualitative and quantitative data sources.

Adapting the Coding Approach

During analysis, the team recognized that the open-ended survey item (“What is one change you would make to the program?”) was framed in a way that invited criticism, which likely skewed qualitative responses toward negative sentiment. Rather than classifying responses by sentiment alone as originally planned, the team developed a codebook that coded by both theme and sentiment. This update gave the team a clearer view of what specifically participants were reacting to, not just whether the reaction was positive or negative. It also made the recommendations more actionable. The team could tie specific themes like self-paced module pacing or mentor inconsistency, directly to patterns in the data. Future evaluations should anticipate that question framing will shape qualitative data, and build in thematic coding from the start or find a way to avoid semantic coding altogether.

Designing for Future Comparisons

The team had no usable baseline data from prior years, which made it impossible to assess whether current results represent improvement, decline, or a steady state. The project timeline also limited what the team could collect. Going forward, the evaluation team recommends that Tamrack design its ongoing feedback instruments with future comparisons in mind, so that the next evaluation has a baseline to work from.

8. REPORTING

This written report is the primary deliverable for the evaluation project. The report was submitted to the client, Gill Gibson, Director of Learning and Performance Solutions, and is intended for use by the LPS team and the Human Resources Director.

The evaluation team recommends presenting these findings to the client and available stakeholders in a follow-up session. That session would cover the methodology, walk through key findings for each dimension, and give stakeholders a chance to ask questions and discuss which recommendations to prioritize.

All raw data, coded interview transcripts, and analysis materials are archived by the evaluation team. Access to these materials is available to the client on request. Survey data remains anonymized. Interview recordings were destroyed after transcription, as outlined in the informed consent agreements.

If the client is interested, the evaluation team can also support early implementation planning. This could include a working session to prioritize the recommendations and assign ownership, along with practical tools like a sample mentor touchpoint schedule, a draft supervisor checklist, or example approaches for restructuring the self-paced modules. Full implementation falls outside the scope of this evaluation, but these starting points are available if they would be useful.

DECLARATION OF AI USAGE

Grammarly (2026) was used for editing support in the writing of this document. This included grammar, spelling, vocabulary, and phrasing adjustments to improve conciseness and tone consistency. All analytical work, evaluation, and conclusions are entirely the authors' own. All suggestions were reviewed and approved by the authors.

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APPENDICES

Appendix A. Program Materials

A.1 Day One Synchronous Orientation Schedule

The following is the schedule template provided by the client for the first-day virtual orientation session.

Outline/Schedule of the Video Conferencing Orientation Program

Orientation Session: Welcome to Tamrack, Inc.

Date: [Orientation Date]

Time: 9:00 AM – 1:00 PM MT

Platform: [Video Conferencing Tool Name]

Meeting Link: [Meeting Link]

9:00 AM – 9:15 AM: Welcome and Introduction

- **Host:** [HR Representative's Name]
- Brief welcome message and introductions
- Overview of the day's agenda

9:15 AM – 9:45 AM: Company Culture

- **Presenter:** [CEO or Senior Executive]
- Company mission, vision, and values
- Our history and growth
- Core values and how they shape our work environment
- Diversity, inclusion, and community involvement initiatives

9:45 AM – 10:15 AM: Organizational Structure

- **Presenter:** [Department Head or HR Representative]
- Overview of the organizational structure
- Key departments and their functions
- Introduction to senior leadership and management teams

10:15 AM – 10:30 AM: Break

- 15-minute break for refreshments and personal time

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM: Company Policies

- **Presenter:** [HR Representative]
- Code of conduct and professional behavior
- Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) and anti-discrimination policies
- Anti-harassment and anti-bullying policies
- Confidentiality and data protection

11:00 AM – 11:30 AM: Remote Work and Telework Policies

- **Presenter:** [HR Representative or IT Specialist]
- Telework policy overview
- Setting up a productive home office
- Communication and collaboration expectations
- IT support and resources for remote work

11:30 AM – 12:00 PM: Employee Benefits

- **Presenter:** [HR Benefits Specialist]
- Overview of health insurance and benefits
- Retirement plans and financial planning resources
- Employee Assistance Program (EAP)
- Paid Time Off (PTO) and leave policies

12:00 PM – 12:15 PM: Professional Development

- **Presenter:** [Training and Development Coordinator]
- Training and development opportunities
- Performance reviews and feedback process
- Career pathways and promotion criteria
- Tuition reimbursement program

12:15 PM – 12:45 PM: Health and Safety

- **Presenter:** [Health and Safety Officer]
- Workplace safety guidelines and emergency procedures
- Ergonomics and setting up a safe home office
- COVID-19 health and safety protocols

12:45 PM – 1:00 PM: Q&A and Closing Remarks

- Open floor for questions from new hires
- Summary of key points from the session
- Final words of welcome and encouragement

- Next steps and resources available in the pre-boarding portal

1:00 PM – 2:00 PM: Break

- 1-hour break for lunch and personal time
-

Post-Orientation:

- **2:00 PM – 3:00 PM:** Virtual meet-and-greet with managers and team members
- **Platform:** [Video Conferencing Tool Name]
- **Meeting Link:** [Meeting Link]

- **3:00 PM – 4:00 PM:** Virtual meet-and-greet with mentors
- **Platform:** [Video Conferencing Tool Name]
- **Meeting Link:** [Meeting Link]

A.2 Self-Paced eLearning Module Outline

The following is an outline of the self-paced e-learning modules new hires complete the second day through the learning management system.

Outline/Schedule of Self-Paced Online Course: Compliance Training

Course Title: Compliance Training for New Employees

Duration: Approximately 4 hours

Platform: [Learning Management System Name]

Course Access: [Course Link]

Module 1: Introduction to Compliance (30 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Importance of compliance in the workplace
 - Objectives of compliance training

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Definition of compliance
 - The role of employees in ensuring compliance
 - Overview of key compliance areas

Module 2: Code of Conduct (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Understanding the company's Code of Conduct
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Ethical behavior and decision-making
 - Professional behavior standards
 - Reporting unethical behavior
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Scenario-based questions
 - Case studies

Module 3: Anti-Harassment and Discrimination Policies (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Promoting a respectful workplace
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Types of harassment and discrimination
 - Company policies on anti-harassment and discrimination
 - Reporting procedures and support
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Quizzes
 - Real-life scenario simulations

Module 4: Data Protection and Confidentiality (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Ensuring data security and confidentiality
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Company policies on data protection
 - Best practices for maintaining confidentiality
 - Handling sensitive information
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Knowledge checks
 - Data protection scenarios

Module 5: Health and Safety Compliance (30 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Maintaining a safe and healthy workplace
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Company health and safety policies
 - Emergency procedures
 - Ergonomics and home office safety
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Safety quizzes
 - Emergency response scenarios

Module 6: Anti-Bribery and Corruption (30 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Preventing bribery and corruption
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Company policies on bribery and corruption
 - Identifying and reporting bribery
 - Legal implications and consequences
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Case studies
 - Scenario-based questions

Module 7: Compliance with Industry Regulations (30 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Understanding industry-specific regulations
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Key regulations affecting the industry
 - Company's approach to compliance with these regulations
 - Role of employees in maintaining compliance
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Regulation quizzes
 - Application scenarios

Module 8: Final Assessment (30 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Assessing understanding of compliance topics
- **Assessment:**
 - Multiple-choice questions
 - Scenario-based questions
- **Passing Criteria:**
 - 80% or higher to pass the course

Completion and Certification:

- **Certificate of Completion:**
 - Upon successful completion of the final assessment, employees will receive a certificate of completion.
 - **Next Steps:**
 - Employees are encouraged to review any areas of uncertainty and retake modules if necessary.
 - Continuous learning resources and updates on compliance policies will be available in the employee portal.
-

Outline/Schedule of Self-Paced Online Course: Job-Specific Skills Training

Course Title: Job-Specific Skills Training for New Employees

Duration: Approximately 6 hours

Platform: [Learning Management System Name]

Course Access: [Course Link]

Module 1: Introduction to Job-Specific Skills (20 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Importance of job-specific skills in achieving success
 - Objectives of the job-specific skills training course
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Definition and examples of job-specific skills
 - Overview of the course structure

Module 2: Technical Skills (1 hour)

- **Overview:**
 - Mastering the technical skills required for the job
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Introduction to [specific software/tools used]
 - Basic functions and features
 - Advanced functionalities and tips
- **Interactive Activities:**

- Hands-on exercises with [software/tool]
- Quizzes to test knowledge

Module 3: Industry Knowledge (1 hour)

- **Overview:**
 - Understanding the industry landscape
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Key industry trends and developments
 - Competitive analysis
 - Regulatory environment and compliance requirements
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Case studies
 - Industry-related quizzes

Module 4: Product and Service Knowledge (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Gaining in-depth knowledge of the company's products and services
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Overview of key products/services
 - Unique selling points and features
 - Customer use cases and success stories
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Product/service quizzes
 - Scenario-based exercises

Module 5: Customer Interaction Skills (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Enhancing customer interaction skills specific to the job
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Effective communication with customers
 - Managing customer expectations
 - Handling common customer issues and inquiries
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Role-playing exercises
 - Customer interaction simulations

Module 6: Project Management Skills (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Developing project management skills for job success

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Introduction to project management principles
 - Planning and organizing tasks
 - Time management and prioritization
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Project planning exercises
 - Task management scenarios

Module 7: Data Analysis and Reporting (1 hour)

- **Overview:**
 - Learning data analysis and reporting techniques relevant to the job
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Introduction to data analysis tools
 - Basic data analysis techniques
 - Creating and interpreting reports
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Data analysis exercises
 - Report creation tasks

Module 8: Problem-Solving Skills (45 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Enhancing problem-solving skills specific to job tasks
- **Topics Covered:**
 - Identifying and analyzing problems
 - Developing effective solutions
 - Implementing and evaluating solutions
- **Interactive Activities:**
 - Problem-solving scenarios
 - Case study analysis

Module 9: Final Assessment (30 minutes)

- **Overview:**
 - Assessing understanding of job-specific skills topics
- **Assessment:**
 - Multiple-choice questions
 - Scenario-based questions
- **Passing Criteria:**
 - 80% or higher to pass the course

Completion and Certification:

- **Certificate of Completion:**
 - Upon successful completion of the final assessment, employees will receive a certificate of completion.
 - **Next Steps:**
 - Employees are encouraged to review any areas of uncertainty and retake modules if necessary.
 - Continuous learning resources and updates on job-specific skills will be available in the employee portal.
-

Outline/Schedule of Self-Paced Online Course: Soft Skills Training

Course Title: Soft Skills Training for New Employees

Duration: 4-5 hours

Platform: [Learning Management System Name]

Course Access: Preview - <https://rise.articulate.com/share/rqy8qXNoo6TcRcbk0sui1FSsdKNtYDgQ>

Course Introduction (10 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Welcome
 - Course Objectives

Module 1: Introduction to Soft Skills (20 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Definition of soft skills
 - Importance of soft skills
 - Differentiating between soft skills and hard skills

Module 2: Communication Skills (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Why communication matters
 - Verbal and non-verbal communication
 - Strategies for effective communication
 - Effective writing skills
 - Giving and receiving feedback

- **Quiz:**
 - Communication skills

Module 3: Team Dynamics (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Team dynamics and why they matter
 - Characteristics of high performing teams
 - Tips for improving team dynamics
 - Managing the multigenerational workplace
- **Quiz:**
 - Team dynamics

Module 4: Time Management (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Best practices of time management
 - Symptoms for poor time management
 - Ways to track your time
 - Tips for effective time management at work
- **Quiz:**
 - Time management

Module 5: Emotional Intelligence (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - What is EQ?
 - Improving self-awareness, self-regulation, self-motivation
 - Developing empathy
 - Enhancing social skills

Module 6: Problem Solving (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Problem-solving process
 - Problem-solving skills and strategies
 - Managing complicated vs. complex problems
 - Overcoming barriers to effective problem-solving

Module 7: Leadership and Influence (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - Different leadership styles

Module 8: Handling Workplace Problems (30 minutes)

- **Topics Covered:**
 - A leader's role in solving problems
 - Problem prevention and detection
 - Problem-solving process
 - Creative ways of solving problems
 - Overcoming barriers to creative problem-solving
- **Quiz:**
 - Workplace problems

Course Summary

A.3 Post-Orientation Feedback Survey

The following survey is administered to new hires at the end of the new hire's first month. At the time of this evaluation, this was the organization's only existing feedback instrument for the NEO program.

Figure A1. Post-Orientation Feedback Survey (1 of 6)

New Employee Onboarding Feedback Survey

Purpose: We value your feedback to help us improve our onboarding program. Please take a few minutes to complete this survey and share your thoughts about your onboarding experience at Tamrack, Inc.



* Indicates required question

1. Name: (optional)

Your answer

2. Position: (optional)

Your answer

3. Department: (optional)

Your answer

4. Start Date: (optional)

Date

02/27/2026

Figure A2. Post-Orientation Feedback Survey (2 of 6)

5. How would you rate your overall pre-boarding experience? *

☐ Excellent

☐ Good

☐ Fair

☐ Poor

6. Did you receive the welcome emails and access to the pre-boarding portal in a timely manner? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

7. How helpful were the resources provided in the pre-boarding portal (e.g., company handbook, introductory videos)? *

☐ Very Helpful

☐ Helpful

☐ Neutral

☐ Not Helpful

8. Any comments or suggestions for improving the pre-boarding process?

Your answer _____

Figure A3. Post-Orientation Feedback Survey (3 of 6)

9. How would you rate the overall effectiveness of the first-day orientation sessions? *

☐ Excellent

☐ Good

☐ Fair

☐ Poor

10. Were the orientation sessions informative and engaging? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

11. How well did the orientation sessions cover the following topics? *

	Very Well	Well	Neutral	Poorly
Company Culture:	☐	☐	☐	☐
Company Policies and Procedures:	☐	☐	☐	☐
Remote Work Policies:	☐	☐	☐	☐
Employee Benefits:	☐	☐	☐	☐
Health and Safety:	☐	☐	☐	☐

12. Any comments or suggestions for improving the orientation sessions?

Your answer

Figure A4. Post-Orientation Feedback Survey (4 of 6)

13. How would you rate the effectiveness of the self-paced training modules? *

☐ Excellent

☐ Good

☐ Fair

☐ Poor

14. How well did the training modules help you understand the following topics? *

	Very Well	Well	Neutral	Poorly
Compliance:	☐	☐	☐	☐
Job-Specific Skills:	☐	☐	☐	☐
Soft Skills:	☐	☐	☐	☐

15. Were the interactive activities and assessments in the training modules helpful? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

16. Any comments or suggestions for improving the training modules?

Your answer _____

Figure A5. Post-Orientation Feedback Survey (5 of 6)

17. How would you rate your experience with your assigned mentor? *

☐ Excellent

☐ Good

☐ Fair

☐ Poor

18. Did your mentor provide helpful guidance and support during your onboarding process? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

19. Any comments or suggestions for improving the mentorship program?

Your answer _____

Figure A6. Post-Orientation Feedback Survey (6 of 6)

20. How would you rate your overall onboarding experience at Tamrack, Inc.? *

☐ Excellent

☐ Good

☐ Fair

☐ Poor

21. Do you feel prepared to perform your job duties effectively after completing the onboarding program? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

22. Any additional comments or suggestions for improving the onboarding program?

Your answer

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Google Forms

Appendix B. Feasibility and Risk Factors

B.1 Feasibility

The following is a summary of the evaluation team's assessment of project feasibility:

1. **Maturity.** The virtual format of the first-week New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program has been implemented since 2020. With approximately five years of implementation experience and recurring monthly delivery cycles, the program is sufficiently mature to allow for meaningful evaluation. In addition, prior employee survey data and existing training materials provided adequate historical information to support analysis of program strengths and areas for improvement.
2. **Scope.** The evaluation focused exclusively on the first week of the NEO program. Pre-boarding activities and the informal first-month integration period are excluded from the scope. Limiting the evaluation to the structured first week of onboarding increased feasibility and allowed the project to be completed within the defined timeframe. Clear scope boundaries reduced the likelihood of scope creep and enabled focused data collection aligned to evaluation objectives.
3. **Support.** The client, Gill Gibson, demonstrated strong support for the evaluation. She provided access to onboarding materials, training outlines, and prior survey data. Although the Human Resources Director was unavailable, the client expressed willingness to facilitate communication with other stakeholders where possible. The intended users of the findings (HR Director, LPS Director, and instructional designers) indicated interest in using the evaluation results to improve the onboarding program.
4. **Ethical concerns.** No significant ethical concerns were identified. However, several considerations were monitored. The evaluation relied primarily on one upstream stakeholder as the main point of contact, which limited access to historical context or alternative perspectives. Confidentiality of survey and interview data was maintained, and participation in data collection was voluntary. Sensitive findings were reported in a manner that protects individual anonymity.
5. **Resources.** The following resources were used during this evaluation:
 - a. **Expertise/capacity**
 - i. The evaluation team has developing-level expertise in program evaluation, survey design, interview facilitation, and report writing. The project benefited from structured supervision by a university instructor with expertise in evaluation methodology.
 - ii. The university instructor who supervised the project (level: expert)
 - b. **Funds**
 - i. No additional financial costs were imposed on the client organization for this evaluation.
 - c. **Time**
 - i. The evaluation was conducted within the academic project timeline. The evaluation team committed the necessary time to implement the approved evaluation plan and submit a final report. The client and participating

stakeholders were expected to commit a reasonable amount of time to provide the requested data and to participate in interviews or surveys.

d. Facilities/communication

- i. Most interactions between the evaluation team and the client/stakeholders occurred via e-mail or web conferencing. Training materials and documentation were shared electronically. No on-site visits were required for this evaluation.

B.2 Risk Factors

Risk factors and the risk assessment matrix are presented in Section 4.2.

Appendix C. Data Collection Methods and Rubrics

C.1 Instruments, Rubrics, and Triangulation Rubric

Table C.1 Instruments and Rubrics Development Worksheet

Dimension, PLM, and IW	Rationale for Using Multiple Sets of Data (Critical Multiplism and Triangulation)	Data Collection Method	Instrument to Be Developed	Rubric to Be Used
Role Readiness: How well does orientation prepare employees to work with their manager to learn their role responsibilities? How effective are the orientation materials and activities in enabling new employees to start learning their role with their manager? ● PLM: Activities, Outcomes ● Importance Weighting: Critical (1)	Surveys of managers and NEO participants efficiently reach the full population and provide quantitative and qualitative self-reported data from two different stakeholder groups. However, surveys are limited in depth, vulnerable to low response rates, and rely on self-assessment. Semi-structured interviews with managers and NEO completers compensate for the weaknesses of surveys. They are likely to generate more detailed qualitative data about how prepared new hires feel and how they actually show up after onboarding, such as revealing knowledge gaps, recurring questions, or readiness issues that surveys cannot surface. Interviews also provide a fallback source for stakeholders’ voices if survey response rates are low. Since Tamrack is a remote-first company, stakeholders likely already have video conferencing technology. Together, these methods triangulate how participants and managers perceive its effectiveness (surveys) and what deeper experiential insights reveal (interviews).	1.1 Self-administered, anonymous online survey of all managers of employees who completed the NEO program in 2025 (n = 24) to provide quantitative and qualitative data regarding new hire role readiness.	1.1 Semi-structured survey questionnaire uploaded to a web-based survey system and a survey invitation email	● Rubric 1.1: Manager Survey (Role Readiness) ● Likert Items: Q3-Q5, Q7-Q10 ● Open-ended: Q11b, Q12 ● Binary: Q11a (reported as a percentage) ● Exclude: Q6 (Used in Dimension 2)
		1.2 Self-administered, anonymous online survey of all NEO participants who completed the program between January 1 and December 31st, 2025 (n = approximately 30) to provide quantitative and qualitative data regarding role readiness.	1.2 Semi-structured survey questionnaire uploaded to a web-based survey system and a survey invitation email	● Rubric 1.2: Participant Survey (Role Readiness) ● Likert Items: Q13-Q21 ● Open-ended: Q22 ● Exclude: Q8-Q12 (used in Dimension 2)
		1.3 Voluntary, semi-structured one-on-one video conference interviews (approximately 30 minutes) with managers from all applicable departments whose employees completed the NEO program in 2025 (n = approximately 7-10). Participants will be selected via purposive sampling to	1.3 Semi-structured interview instrument including an interview solicitation email, informed consent form, and interview questions	● Rubric 1.3: Manager Interview (Role Readiness) ● Scaled Item: Q2 ● Qualitative: Q1, Q3-Q8

		gather in-depth qualitative data on new hire role readiness.		
		1.4 Voluntary, semi-structured one-on-one video conference interviews (approximately 30 minutes) with NEO participants who completed the program in 2025 (n = approximately 7-10). Participants will be selected via purposive sampling to gather in-depth qualitative data on new hire role readiness.	1.4 Semi-structured interview instrument including an interview solicitation email, informed consent form, and interview questions	• Rubric 1.4: Participant Interview (Role Readiness) • Scaled Item: Q8 • Qualitative: Q2, Q5, Q7-Q10
Feeling Welcomed: How effectively does the orientation program incorporate and present company culture and values? How well does the orientation program incorporate materials, activities, and messaging that support a welcoming environment? • PLM: Activities, Outcomes • Importance Weighting: Critical (1)	The survey of NEO participants provides self-reported perceptions of feeling welcomed from the full population, but is limited in depth and vulnerable to low response rates. Semi-structured interviews with 7-10 recent NEO completers compensate for the limitations of surveys by generating more detailed qualitative data about the lived experience of being onboarded, for example, whether the mentor pairing happened, how the synchronous session felt, or whether the async LMS experience felt isolating or supportive. Interviews serve as a fallback if survey response rates are low. Together, these methods triangulate how the full population perceives the program (survey) and what individual experiences reveal in depth (interviews).	2.1 Self-administered, anonymous online survey of all NEO participants (approximately 30 minutes) who completed the program in 2025 (n = approximately 30) to provide qualitative feedback regarding company culture, values, and feeling welcomed.	Included in 1.2	• Rubric 2.1: Participant Survey (Feeling Welcomed) • Likert Items: Q8-Q11 • Open-ended: Q12 • Exclude: Q13-Q22 (used in Dimension 1)
		2.2 Voluntary, semi-structured video conference interviews with NEO participants who completed the program in 2025 (n = approximately 7-10). Participants will be selected via purposive sampling to gather in-depth qualitative data on company culture, values, and feeling welcomed.	Included in 1.4	• Rubric 2.2: Participant Interview (Feeling Welcomed) • Scaled Item: Q3 • Qualitative: Q2, Q4-Q6

IW, Importance weighting; PLM, program logic model

Table C.2 Dimensional Triangulation Rubric Worksheet

Dimension, PLM, and IW	Data collection method	Exceeds Expectations	Met Expectations	Improvement Needed	Serious Problems Detected	Dimensional triangulation rubric
Role Readiness: How well does orientation prepare employees to work with their manager to learn their role responsibilities? How effective are the orientation materials and activities in enabling new employees to start learning their role with their manager? ● PLM: Activities, Outcomes ● Importance Weighting: Critical (1)	1.1 Manager survey (Q3-Q6, Q8-Q11)	4.0 ≤ average ≤ 5.0 without any “Strongly disagree” or “Somewhat disagree” responses	3.0 ≤ average < 4.0	2.0 ≤ average < 3.0	1.0 ≤ average < 2.0	● Exceeds Expectations: At least three of four data sources indicate “Exceeds Expectations,” and no source indicates “Improvement Needed” or “Serious Problems” ● Met Expectations: At least three of four data sources indicate “Met Expectations” or higher, and no source indicates “Serious Problems Detected.” ● Improvement Needed: Two or more data sources indicate “Improvement Needed,” or any single source indicates “Serious Problems Detected.” ● Serious Problems Detected: Two or more data sources indicate “Serious Problems Detected.”
	1.2 Participant Survey (Q13-Q21)	4.0 ≤ average ≤ 5.0 without any “Strongly disagree” or “Somewhat disagree” responses	3.0 ≤ average < 4.0	2.0 ≤ average < 3.0	1.0 ≤ average < 2.0	
	1.3 Manager interview (Scaled: Q2; Qualitative: Q1, Q3-Q8) Note: Q12a (binary) is reported as a percentage and used as supplementary context, not as a standalone rubric source.	4.0 ≤ average ≤ 5.0, and comments indicate that NEO adequately prepared new hires to begin learning their role responsibilities with their manager, including relevant tools and software.	3.0 ≤ average < 4.0, and comments indicate that NEO generally prepared new hires to begin learning their role, with minor gaps identified.	2.0 ≤ average < 3.0, and comments indicate notable gaps in new hire preparedness for role responsibilities.	1.0 ≤ average < 2.0, and comments indicate that new hires were not adequately prepared to begin learning their role.	

Dimension, PLM, and IW	Data collection method	Exceeds Expectations	Met Expectations	Improvement Needed	Serious Problems Detected	Dimensional triangulation rubric
	1.4 Participant Interview (Scaled: Q8; Qualitative: Q2, Q5, Q7-10)	4.0 ≤ average ≤ 5.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants felt that they were well prepared to begin working with their manager and team.	3.0 ≤ average < 4.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants generally felt that they were prepared to begin working with their manager and team.	2.0 ≤ average < 3.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants felt that they were somewhat unprepared to begin working with their manager and team.	1.0 ≤ average < 2.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants felt that they were unprepared to begin working with their manager and team.	
Feeling Welcomed: How effectively does the orientation program incorporate and present company culture and values? How well does the orientation program incorporate materials, activities, and messaging that support a welcoming environment? ● PLM: Activities, Outcomes ● Importance Weighting: Critical (1)	2.1 Participant Survey (Q8-Q11)	4.0 ≤ average ≤ 5.0 without any “Strongly disagree” or “Somewhat disagree” responses	3.0 ≤ average < 4.0	2.0 ≤ average < 3.0	1.0 ≤ average < 2.0	● Exceeds Expectations: Both data sources indicate “Exceeds Expectations.” ● Met Expectations: Both data sources indicate “Met Expectations” or higher. ● Improvement Needed: Either data source indicates “Improvement Needed,” with neither indicating “Serious Problems Detected.” ● Serious Problems Detected: Either data source indicates “Serious Problems Detected.”
	2.2 Participant Interview (Scaled: Q3; Qualitative: Q2, Q4-Q6)	4.0 ≤ average ≤ 5.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants felt that orientation effectively communicated company culture and values and made them feel welcomed.	3.0 ≤ average < 4.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants generally felt that orientation communicated company culture and values and made them feel welcomed.	2.0 ≤ average < 3.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants felt that orientation did not consistently communicate company culture and values or support a welcoming environment.	1.0 ≤ average < 2.0, and comments indicate that NEO participants felt that orientation did not effectively communicate company culture and values or support a welcoming environment.	

Appendix D. Evaluation Instruments

D.1-1 Manager Survey Invitation Email

Subject: Invitation: Share Your Experience with Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding Program

Hello [name],

Tamrack's Learning Performance and Solutions team is conducting an evaluation of our New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program to better understand how well it supports new hires and where we can make improvements.

Because you manage an employee who recently completed the onboarding program, we would greatly value your feedback.

Your responses will help us identify strengths of the onboarding program and areas where improvements may be needed. We have partnered with an evaluation team from Boise State University to conduct this survey and analyze the results.

Participation is voluntary, and you may choose to withdraw at any time. Your responses will remain anonymous, and the results will be used only to help improve the onboarding experience for future Tamrack employees.

The survey should take approximately 20 minutes to complete. We will collect survey results between March 23rd through April 3rd.

Please click the link below to begin the survey:

https://qualtricsxm8qs6m24gf.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_82MfzcNTQa4OZUy

Thank you for taking the time to share your experience.

Sincerely,

Gill Gibson

Director, Learning and Performance Solutions

Tamrack, Inc

D.1-1 Manager Evaluation Survey

Tamrack NEO Evaluation Survey - Managers

Introduction Thank you for taking the time to complete this survey. Your feedback is an important part of a formal evaluation of Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program. This survey asks about your experience with new employees who completed the onboarding program in 2025. Specifically, we

are interested in how well the program prepares new employees to begin working with you and your team. Your responses will help identify what the program is doing well and where it can be improved so that new employees arrive better prepared for their roles.

Your responses are anonymous and will be reported only in aggregate.

Instructions: If you managed one new hire in 2025, respond based on that individual's experience. If you managed more than one, respond based on your overall experience with new employees. For each statement, select the option that best represents your level of agreement using your observations of new hires right after they completed the onboarding program.

Time to Complete: 5-10 minutes I have read the information above and agree to participate in the survey.*

☐ Yes (1)

Start of Block: Section 1 - Background

Background This section asks a few questions about your onboarding experience and professional background.

1 What department do you work in?

☐ Customer Service (1)

☐ Finance (2)

☐ HR (3)

☐ IT (4)

☐ Operations (5)

☐ Sales (6)

☐ Other (Please specify) (7) _____

2 How many new hires did you manage who completed the NEO program in 2025?

☐ 1 (1)

☐ 2 (2)

☐ 3 (3)

☐ 4 or more (4)

Start of Block: Section 2 - Feeling Welcomed and Company Culture

Foundational Knowledge Preparedness

For the following questions, think about your new hire(s) during the first few days after they completed the orientation program, before you began role-specific training with them.

3 My new hire(s) understood Tamrack's policies covered during orientation (e.g., code of conduct, anti-harassment, EEO, data protection, anti-bribery, industry regulations).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

4 My new hire(s) understood remote work and communication expectations covered during orientation (e.g., telework policies, collaboration tools, IT support resources).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

5 My new hire(s) understood workplace safety topics covered during orientation (e.g., safety guidelines, emergency procedures, ergonomic practices).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

6 My new hire(s) could describe Tamrack's core values as presented during orientation (e.g., the company's mission, cultural values, commitment to diversity and inclusion).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)

- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

Start of Block: Section 3 - Role Readiness

Systems and Resources This section asks about how well the New Employee Orientation program prepares new hire to begin working in their role.

7 My new hire(s) had functional access to the systems and tools needed to begin their role (e.g., laptop, VPN, email, learning management system).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

8 My new hire(s) knew who to contact for different types of support (e.g., IT for technical issues, HR for policy questions, their mentor for informal guidance).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

9 In the first few weeks, my new hire(s) directed questions to appropriate people rather than defaulting to me.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)

- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

Start of Block: Program Gaps

10 Overall, my new hire(s) were prepared to begin learning their role with me and the team after completing orientation.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

11 Did you need to spend time teaching new hires foundational information before you could begin role-specific training?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

11b What topics or areas required additional time?

12 Is there anything else you would like to share about the readiness of new hires following the onboarding program?

D.1-2 Participant Survey Invitation

Subject: Invitation: Share Your Experience with Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding Program

Hello [name],

The Learning and Performance Solutions team is conducting an evaluation of our New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program to better understand how well it supports new hires and where we can make improvements.

Because you recently completed the onboarding program, we would greatly value your feedback.

Your responses will help us identify strengths of the onboarding program and areas where improvements may be needed. We have partnered with an evaluation team from Boise State University to conduct this survey and analyze the results.

Participation is voluntary, and you may choose to withdraw at any time. Your responses will remain anonymous, and the results will be used only to help improve the onboarding experience for future Tamrack employees.

The survey should take approximately 25 minutes to complete. We will collect survey results between March 23rd through April 3rd.

Please click the link below to begin the survey:

https://qualtricsxm8qs6m24gf.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_cAxG9VnCYZ9q2qy

Thank you for taking the time to share your experience.

Sincerely,

Gill Gibson

Director, Learning and Performance Solutions

Tamrack, Inc

D.1-2 Participant Survey

Tamrack NEO Evaluation Survey - Participants

Introduction You are receiving this survey because you completed the Tamrack New Employee Orientation (NEO) program in 2025. Please think about your experience with the NEO program and your early work experience at Tamrack when responding to the following statements. Your responses are anonymous and will be reported only in aggregate. They will help evaluate how well the NEO prepares new employees and supports a welcoming workplace environment. Time to Complete: 10 minutes I have read the information above and agree to participate in the survey.*

☐ Yes (1)

Start of Block: Section 1 - Background

Background This section asks a few questions about your onboarding experience and professional background.

1 When did you complete the New Employee Orientation program in 2025?

- ☐ January-March
- ☐ April-June
- ☐ July-September
- ☐ October-December
- ☐ I don't remember

2 How many years of prior work experience do you have related to your role at Tamrack? Approximately _____ years

3 What is your role?

- ☐ Customer Service (1)
- ☐ Finance (2)
- ☐ HR (3)
- ☐ IT (4)
- ☐ Operations (5)
- ☐ Sales (6)
- ☐ Other (Please specify) (7) _____

4 How did you participate in the NEO program?

- ☐ Fully online (1)
- ☐ Mostly online with some in-person (2)
- ☐ Fully in-person (3)

5 During your first week, did you meet with your manager?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)
- ☐ I don't remember (3)

6 During your first week, did you meet with your team?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)
- ☐ I don't remember (3)

7 During your first week, did you meet with your mentor?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)
- ☐ I don't remember (3)

Start of Block: Section 2 - Feeling Welcomed and Company Culture

Feeling Welcomed and Company Culture

This section asks about your experience with Tamrack's culture and whether the New Employee Orientation program helped you feel welcomed.

8 The NEO program helped me understand Tamrack's culture and values (e.g., the company's mission, core values, and commitment to diversity and inclusion).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

9 The NEO program helped me feel welcomed as a new employee.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

10 The NEO program helped me feel like I am part of the Tamrack organization.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

11 Overall, I found the NEO program was a valuable introduction to the company's culture and values.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

12 What is one change to the NEO that would have helped you feel more welcomed at Tamrack?

Start of Block: Section 3 - Role Readiness

Role Readiness This section asks about how well the New Employee Orientation program prepared you to begin working in your role.

13 The NEO program helped me understand Tamrack's policies covered during orientation (e.g., code of conduct, anti-harassment, EEO, data protection, anti-bribery, industry regulations).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

14 The NEO program helped me understand Tamrack's remote work and communication expectations (e.g., telework policies, collaboration tools, home office setup).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

15 The NEO program helped me understand workplace safety topics (e.g., safety guidelines, emergency procedures, ergonomic practices).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

16 The self-paced online training modules were an effective way to learn the material.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

17 Which self-paced training course(s), if any, did you find most useful? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ Compliance Training (1)
- ☐ Job-Specific Skills Training (2)
- ☐ Soft Skills Training (3)
- ☐ None of the above (4)
- ☐ I don't remember (5)

18 By the end of my first week, I had functional access to systems needed to begin my role (e.g. laptop, VPN, email, learning management system).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

19 After completing the NEO program, I knew who to contact when I had questions (e.g., IT for technical issues, HR for policy questions, my mentor for guidance).

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

20 The NEO program prepared me to begin learning my role with my manager and team.

- ☐ Strongly disagree (1)
- ☐ Somewhat disagree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Somewhat agree (4)
- ☐ Strongly agree (5)
- ☐ I don't know (99)

21 What is one change to the NEO program that would have helped you start learning your role more effectively?

D.1-3 Manager Interview Consent Form

Informed Consent Form

STUDY TITLE: Tamrack New Employee Orientation Evaluation

INVESTIGATORS: Ana Jackson, Casey Shiray, Ryan Delfino, Patrick Smith (Team CARP).

SPONSOR: Gill Gibson, Director of LPS

APPROVAL: This evaluation project has been approved by Tamrack's leadership

PURPOSE: Determine the effectiveness of the Tamrack New Employee Orientation program

PROCEDURE: Gill Gibson will contact you via email to schedule an interview date and time. The interview will be conducted via Zoom and will last for about 30 minutes. With your permission, we will video-record the interview for transcription only, and then we will destroy the file after the transcript is complete.

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION: Your participation in this evaluation project is voluntary. You may decline or stop at any time without penalty. Your choice will not affect your job, performance review, pay, benefits, promotion opportunities, work assignments, or employment status.

CONFIDENTIALITY: The evaluation team will keep any potentially identifiable information confidential. Your individual responses will not be shared with your supervisor or anyone in your management chain. Only a summary of data will be presented in a report, and your name will not be used in any written reports or publications that result from this needs assessment.

RISKS: There are minimal risks associated with this interview. If you do not feel comfortable answering any of the questions during the interview, you can skip the question or stop participating in the interview at any time.

BENEFITS: By submitting your input, you are sharing helpful information that will provide the data needed to evaluate and update the Tamrack New Employee Orientation program.

QUESTIONS: If you have any questions or concerns about participation in this needs assessment project, please contact Gill Gibson at tamracklpsdirector@gmail.com.

By typing my full name below, I confirm that I am 18 or older, have read and understood this form, and agree to participate voluntarily. I understand I may withdraw at any time without penalty.

Typed Name: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

D.1-3 Manager Interview Consent Email

Subject: Invitation: Interview Regarding Your Experience with Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding Program

Hello [name],

Tamrack's Learning and Performance Solutions team is conducting an evaluation of our New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program to better understand how well it supports new hires and where we can make improvements.

Because you manage an employee who recently completed the onboarding program, we would greatly value your feedback.

Your responses will help us identify strengths of the onboarding program and areas where improvements may be needed. We have partnered with an evaluation team from Boise State University to conduct interviews and analyze the results.

Participation is voluntary, and you may choose to withdraw at any time. Your responses will remain confidential, and the results will be anonymized and used only to help improve the onboarding experience for future Tamrack employees.

Interviews will be held between March 30th and April 3rd and should take approximately 30 minutes to complete.

The attached informed consent document provides additional information requesting your consent to participate in the interview.

If you are willing to participate in this interview, please reply to this email with a date and time for the interview. If you have any questions regarding this interview, feel free to contact me via email or phone.

Thank you for taking the time to share your experience.

Sincerely,

Gill Gibson

Director, Learning and Performance Solutions

Tamrack, Inc

* Attachment: InformedConsentForInterviewManagers.pdf

D.1-3 Manager Interview Script

Problem statement

Tamrack has requested that Team CARP evaluate its New Employee Orientation (NEO) program to improve new hire speed to proficiency, engagement, and team integration. Tamrack's goal is to ensure that new employees arrive at their departments fully prepared to begin learning their role with their manager and team after completing orientation. A key focus of the evaluation is whether the current orientation materials and activities effectively prepare employees to work alongside their managers, mentors, and teams.

Main topic

- Employee role readiness

Opening Script (Read aloud)

Hello, nice to meet you! I'm Gill Gibson, the Learning and Performance Solutions Director here at Tamrack. My team is working with a consulting team to evaluate our New Employee Orientation program, and I'd like to thank you for taking the time to talk with me today.

You were invited because your experience as a manager of a recent new hire gives you a perspective we really want to hear. This will take about 30 minutes, and I have about 8 questions. I may ask some follow-ups depending on where the conversation goes.

A few quick reminders from the consent form you signed: you can stop or skip any question at any time, no pressure at all. I'll be recording audio and video so we can transcribe the conversation, but once we do, we'll destroy the recording. Everything will be anonymized. Your name won't appear in any reports. Speaking of which, I'd like to use a pseudonym for you during the interview. What name would you like me to use?

[Confirm pseudonym with participant]

What you share today will help us understand how well orientation supports new hires and where we can make improvements.

Do you have any questions before we jump in?

[Begin recording the meeting]

Interviewer Instructions (not to be read aloud)

- Ask questions in order.
- Use follow-up probes only if the participant has not already addressed the topic in their response.

- If a response naturally leads into a later question, it's okay to follow that thread and skip ahead. Just make sure all topics get covered by the end.

Manager Interview Questions

1. What do you expect a new employee to know when they finish the New Employee Orientation?

Note: Let them answer freely. If they mention role-specific skills, that's okay. It tells us about their expectations. You don't need to correct them about what the program covers. This question helps us understand what managers think orientation should deliver, which we can compare to what it actually delivers.

2. Think about the new employee(s) who joined your team after completing orientation. On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is not at all prepared and 5 is fully prepared, how prepared were they to begin learning their role?

- a. Follow-up: What made you select this rating?

Note: Write down their number, then move to the follow-up. The number is just an anchor.

3. Did you need to teach new hires any foundational knowledge or skills that you expected orientation to have covered? If so, what?

- a. Follow-up (if answer is yes): How much of your time did this take during those first few weeks?

Note: If they say no, that's a great data point. Move on to Q4. Don't press.

4. When new employees had questions or needed help, how did they go about getting support? Did they come to you for everything, or did they reach out to other people?

- a. Follow-up: Were there situations when the new employee came to you for something that should have gone to someone else, like IT or HR?

Note: Listen for whether the manager describes a pattern (it kept happening) versus a one-time thing. That distinction matters for our analysis.

5. How would you describe new hires' communication and collaboration with you and the team in the first few weeks?

- a. Follow-up: Were there any specific communication behaviors you noticed that seemed new or practiced, versus things that seemed to come naturally to them?

Note: This follow-up is important. We're trying to understand whether the orientation program influenced communication behaviors or whether what managers observed reflects the new hire's existing skills.

6. What specific areas have you seen new employees struggle with coming out of orientation?

a. Follow-up: Were there any issues with system access or navigating required tools?

Note: If they give a short answer, it's okay to sit with the silence for a moment. Respondents often add their most important point after a pause.

7. Have you received any feedback from mentors working with new hires?

a. Follow up (if yes): What are the mentors spending most of their time assisting with?

Note: Many managers may say they haven't had contact with mentors. If so, don't press, just note it and move on. A pattern of managers saying "no" is itself a finding about the mentor program's structure.

8. If you could add or change one specific activity in the orientation to ensure new hires arrive better prepared to begin learning their role, what would it be, and why?

Closing Script (Read aloud)

That's everything I wanted to cover. Do you have any final thoughts or anything else you'd like to share?

[Let them respond]

Thank you so much for your time today. Your input really helps us understand how to improve the orientation program. As I mentioned earlier, I'll transcribe our conversation and remove any identifying information so your responses stay anonymous. If anything comes to mind after today, feel free to send me an email and I'll get right back to you.

Have a great rest of your day!

[Stop the recording]

D.1-4 Participant Interview Consent Form

Informed Consent Form

STUDY TITLE: Tamrack New Employee Orientation Evaluation

INVESTIGATORS: Ana Jackson, Casey Shiray, Ryan Delfino, Patrick Smith (Team CARP).

SPONSOR: Gill Gibson, Director of LPS

APPROVAL: This evaluation project has been approved by Tamrack's leadership

PURPOSE: Determine the effectiveness of the Tamrack New Employee Orientation program

PROCEDURE: Gill Gibson will contact you via email to schedule an interview date and time. The interview will be conducted via Zoom and will last for about 30 minutes. With your permission, we will video-record the interview for transcription only, and then we will destroy the file after the transcript is complete.

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION: Your participation in this evaluation project is voluntary. You may decline or stop at any time without penalty. Your choice will not affect your job, performance review, pay, benefits, promotion opportunities, work assignments, or employment status.

CONFIDENTIALITY: The evaluation team will keep any potentially identifiable information confidential. Your individual responses will not be shared with your supervisor or anyone in your management chain. Only a summary of data will be presented in a report, and your name will not be used in any written reports or publications that result from this needs assessment.

RISKS: There are minimal risks associated with this interview. If you do not feel comfortable answering any of the questions during the interview, you can skip the question or stop participating in the interview at any time.

BENEFITS: By submitting your input, you are sharing helpful information that will provide the data needed to evaluate and update the Tamrack New Employee Orientation program.

QUESTIONS: If you have any questions or concerns about participation in this needs assessment project, please contact Gill Gibson at tamracklpsdirector@gmail.com.

By typing my full name below, I confirm that I am 18 or older, have read and understood this form, and agree to participate voluntarily. I understand I may withdraw at any time without penalty.

Typed Name: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

D.1-4 Participant Interview Consent Email

Subject: Invitation: Interview Regarding Your Experience with Tamrack's New Employee Onboarding Program

Hello [name],

Tamrack's Learning Performance and Solutions team is conducting an evaluation of our New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program to better understand how well it supports new hires and where we can make improvements.

Because you recently completed the onboarding program, we would greatly value your feedback.

Your responses will help us identify strengths of the onboarding program and areas where improvements may be needed. We have partnered with an evaluation team from Boise State University to conduct interviews and analyze the results.

Participation is voluntary, and you may choose to withdraw at any time. Your responses will remain confidential, and the results will be anonymized and used only to help improve the onboarding experience for future Tamrack employees.

Interviews will be held between March 30th and April 5th and should take approximately 30 minutes to complete.

The attached informed consent document provides additional information requesting your consent to participate in the interview.

If you are willing to participate in this interview, please reply to this email with a date and time for the interview. If you have any questions regarding this interview, feel free to contact me via email or phone.

Thank you for taking the time to share your experience.

Sincerely,

Gill Gibson

Director, Learning and Performance Solutions

Tamrack, Inc

* Attachment: InformedConsentForInterviewParticipants.pdf

D.1-4 Participant Interview Script

Problem statement

Tamrack has requested that Team CARP evaluate its New Employee Orientation (NEO) program to improve new hire integration, engagement, and speed to proficiency. Tamrack's goal is to ensure that new employees feel welcomed into the organization and arrive at their departments fully prepared to begin learning their role with their manager and team after completing orientation. A key focus of the evaluation is to what extent the program communicates Tamrack's culture and values and helps new employees feel welcomed into the organization, and whether the current orientation materials and activities effectively prepare employees to work alongside their managers, mentors, and teams.

Main topics

- Employee feeling welcomed

- Employee role readiness

Opening Script (Read aloud)

Hi, nice to meet you! I'm Gill Gibson, the Learning and Performance Solutions Director here at Tamrack. Thank you for taking the time to talk with me today. You were invited because your experience as a recent new hire gives you a perspective we really want to hear.

Here's what to expect: this will take about 30 minutes, and I have about 10 questions. I may ask some follow-ups depending on where the conversation goes.

A few quick reminders from the consent form you signed: you can stop or skip any question at any time, no pressure at all. I'll be recording audio and video so we can transcribe the conversation, but once we do, we'll destroy the recording. Everything will be anonymized — your name won't appear in any reports. Speaking of which, I'd like to use a pseudonym for you during the interview. What name would you like me to use?

[Confirm pseudonym]

What you share today will help us understand what's working in orientation and where we can make improvements.

When answering the following questions, I'd like you to think specifically about your first week at Tamrack, starting with your first official day and the virtual welcome meeting, through the end of that week when you finished the online training modules. We're focused on that structured first week, not the pre-boarding process before your start date or the weeks and months that followed.

Any questions before we jump in?

[Begin recording the meeting]

Interviewer Instructions (Not to be read aloud)

- Ask questions in order.
- Use follow-up probes only if the participant has not already addressed the topic in their response.
- If a response naturally leads into a later question, it's okay to follow that thread and skip ahead. Just make sure all topics get covered by the end.

NEO Participant Interview Questions

1. When did you complete the New Employee Orientation program?
 - a. [Month or Quarter]
2. Thinking back to that first week at Tamrack, what stands out most to you about your experience?
 - a. Follow up: What about [that part] stands out for you?

Note: This is a warm-up question. Let them talk. Whatever they bring up first is likely what mattered most to them. Make a mental note and revisit it later if relevant.

3. On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is not at all welcomed and 5 is very welcomed, how welcomed did you feel during the orientation program?
 - a. Follow up: Can you describe any orientation activities that felt particularly welcoming, or any that felt less welcoming?
4. How well did the orientation help you understand Tamrack's culture and values?
 - a. Follow up (only if needed): What activities do you think communicated the culture really well?
 - b. Follow up (only if needed): What do you think was unclear or confusing about how the culture and values were communicated?
5. How did your early interactions with your manager, mentor, and team shape your first-week experience?
 - a. Follow up: Can you describe any interactions with your manager, mentor, or team that stood out, either positively or negatively?

Note: It's possible some interviewees will not have met with a mentor. If they say they didn't have a mentor interaction, don't press on it. That's a finding in itself. Focus on the manager and team interactions.

6. Did any part of the New Employee Orientation experience make you feel isolated or disconnected?
 - a. Follow up: Were there any parts of the orientation that made you feel especially connected?

Note: If they say no, move to the follow-up about connection. If they say yes, probe with "Can you tell me more about that?" before moving to the follow-up.

7. How did the online training courses you completed on your own affect your onboarding experience?

Note: If they look uncertain, you can clarify: "the online courses you completed on your own during the first week were compliance, soft skills, and job-specific training."

- a. Follow up: Were there any courses that felt particularly useful or not useful?
- b. Follow up: How useful was the soft skills training specifically to your early interactions with your manager and team?
- c. Follow up (if not useful): Was that because you already had those skills, or because the training didn't cover what you needed?

Note: The soft skills follow-ups are important. We're trying to understand whether the communication and teamwork training influenced how new hires worked with their manager and team, or whether they were already bringing those skills with them. If they need a reminder, the soft skills training covered communication, teamwork, time management, and emotional intelligence.

8. On a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 is not prepared at all and 5 is very prepared, how prepared did you feel to begin working with your manager and team after completing orientation?
 - a. Follow-up: Which activities or resources helped you feel most prepared?
 - b. Follow-up: Were there any parts of your role where you felt unprepared when you first started?
9. When you had questions during your first few weeks, how did you figure out who to go to for help?
 - a. Follow up: Were there times when you weren't sure who to ask, or when you went to someone and got redirected to someone else?
10. Based on your own experience, what is one thing Tamrack could change about the orientation program that would have improved your onboarding experience?

Closing Script (Read aloud)

That's everything I wanted to cover. Do you have any final thoughts or anything else you'd like to share?

[Let them respond]

Thank you so much for your time today. Your input really helps us understand how to improve the orientation program. As I mentioned earlier, I'll transcribe our conversation and remove any identifying information so your responses stay anonymous. If anything comes to mind after today, feel free to send me an email and I'll get right back to you.

Have a great rest of your day!

[Stop the recording]

Appendix E. Qualitative Feedback Codebook

Theme	First order code
Feeling Welcome	Social connection
	Disconnection
	Belonging
Role Readiness	System Access
	Knowing who to ask
	Observe real work
	Work with others
	Lack of context
	OJT Training
	Nonspecific (positive)
Program Elements	HR/Admin Tasks
	Self-guided training (elearning)
	Mentoring
	Role-specific content
	Need applied scenarios
	Passive Learning Frustration
	Lack of context
	Cognitive overload
	Company information
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness
	Feeling Welcome
Context (Not included in rubric)	Role/Title
	Tenure/years of experience

	Team/Department
--	-----------------

Codebook Definitions

Code	Definition
Social connection	Interactions and relationship-building with peers, managers, or team members.
Belonging	Related to feeling like part of the Tamrack family
Disconnection	Related to moments of feeling disconnected or isolated
Knowing who to ask	Related to new hires knowing who to go to for specific information or help
System access	Related to logins, tools, set-up, computer systems, etc.
HR/Admin tasks	Related to filling out administrative paperwork or completing HR onboarding tasks such as reviewing and selecting benefits, etc.
Mentoring	Related to the mentoring program or interactions with mentors
Social connection	Related to interactions with peers, manager, team, etc.
Self-guided training	Related to the self-guided elearning modules
Cognitive overload	Mentions of overwhelm, pacing, or memory challenges
Observe real work	Requests for hands-on or observational learning
Work with others	Mentions of interacting with team, peers, or cohort
Role-specific content	Mentions of job-specific content, systems, customers, or tasks
Need applied scenarios	Desire for realistic examples or scenarios that show how to apply knowledge on the job.
Lack of Context	Missing background or explanation needed to understand how content connects to the role or why it matters.
Passive Learning Frustration	Frustration with passive formats (e.g., reading, long eLearning, lectures) that limit engagement

OTJ training	Related to role-specific training done on the job after orientation is complete
Nonspecific (positive)	Positive sentiment without citing specific program elements or details. For example, "It's great to have an orientation to help new employees get started."
Company information	Related to company information in a broad sense without citing specific elements (culture, processes, etc).

Appendix F. Participant Survey Responses

F.1 Likert Scale Responses

Table F.1 Participant Survey Response Frequencies (n=27)

Item	5	4	3	2	1	N/A (0)
Culture and values (Q8)	24	3	0	0	0	0
Feeling welcomed (Q9)	20	7	0	0	0	0
Part of Tamrack organization (Q10)	20	7	0	0	0	0
NEO is a valuable introduction (Q11)	24	3	0	0	0	0
Company policies (Q13)	15	11	1	0	0	0
Remote work and communication expectations (Q14; n=26)	14	11	1	0	0	0
Workplace safety topics (Q15)	12	14	1	0	0	0
Self-paced training modules (Q16)	3	18	0	5	1	0
Access to systems and tools (Q18)	26	1	0	0	0	0
Who to contact for support (Q19)	13	14	0	0	0	0
Role readiness (Q20)	12	15	0	0	0	0

Table F.2 Participant Survey First Week Interactions (n=27)

Item	Yes	No	I don't remember
Met with Manager (Q5)	27	0	0
Met with Team (Q6)	25	2	0
Met with Mentor (Q7)	21	2	4

F.2 Open-ended Survey Responses

Question 12: What is one change to the NEO that would have helped you feel more welcomed at Tamrack?

Respondent	Response
P1	I would have liked more time with [my team].
P2	More opportunities to ask questions during presentations.
P3	Nothing. It was very welcoming.
P4	More interaction with people.
P5	Nothing. It was better than my last company's orientation!
P6	More time to meet with my [team].
P7	nothing
P8	nothing
P9	The virtual training seems impersonal...I would like more interaction with my team the first week, even if it's just to observe some of the work.
P10	More time with my team and less in front of a computer.
P11	Seeing the culture rather than hearing about it.
P12	X
P13	Hearing more from other employees.
P14	More time with my team.
P15	Can't judge culture from presentations. Employee stories/interactions.
P16	Less sitting, more activities.
P17	More information in presentations. Less reading books on the computer.
P18	?
P19	Hearing from employees, more interactions with my team.
P20	Less reading
P21	More interaction with people on my team
P22	More interaction with people who were taking the training at the same time. I only

	met my team that first week. The presentations by others were great, but except for questions, there was no interaction.
P23	More opportunities to work with others during the program.
P24	More interaction with others in my role.
P25	Hearing from more leaders.
P26	Less time alone at a computer.
P27	I would like to hear from other leaders in the organization.

Question 17: Which self-paced training course(s), if any, did you find most useful? (Select all that apply)

Respondent	Response
P1	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P2	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P3	I don't remember
P4	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P5	Compliance Training
P6	Compliance Training
P7	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P8	Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P9	Compliance Training
P10	None of the above
P11	I don't remember
P12	I don't remember
P13	None of the above
P14	None of the above
P15	None of the above
P16	Compliance Training

P17	None of the above
P18	None of the above
P19	Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P20	I don't remember
P21	I don't remember
P22	Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P23	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P24	Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P25	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training, Soft Skills Training
P26	Compliance Training, Job-Specific Skills Training
P27	I don't remember

Q21: What is one change to the NEO program that would have helped you start learning your role more effectively?

Respondent	Response
P1	It was hard at first to judge what content was most relevant to my work. There were no scenarios or examples for us to work through, so I had to try to figure out what was relevant to me.
P2	More examples or scenarios in the elearning.
P3	Too much information too fast in the first week.
P4	Nothing. It was fine.
P5	Too much content to remember. My manager had to review it with me.
P6	Meetings with [peers] to learn about [role] at Tamrack. Most of the information was either basic or geared to [other roles].
P7	nothing
P8	More information about our customers.
P9	Getting started on what I needed for my role right away.
P10	More about the work I was going to do.

P11	More information about how my team/department worked.
P12	Less information in the same amount of time.
P13	Not enough context to understand the online modules. Examples?
P14	The elearning is too long and boring. It was hard to stay focused.
P15	Relevant examples.
P16	More compliance training.
P17	More info specific to my job.
P18	slow down
P19	More structured onboarding from my manager.
P20	More relevant to my job, especially systems.
P21	Too much info. It was hard to make connections
P22	There was so much information to cover! All of those policies! Maybe make it longer with more bite-sized chunks? It was overwhelming.
P23	More content specific to my role.
P24	Examples or scenarios so I understood how to apply the general information to my job.
P25	Stretch out the learning. It's a lot to absorb before starting with the team.
P26	More specific examples, in the compliane [sic] training especially.
P27	More interaction with my team right away

Appendix G. Manager Survey Responses

G.1 Likert Scale Responses

Table G.1 Manager Survey Response Frequencies (n=14)

Item	5	4	3	2	1	N/A (0)
Company policies (Q3; n=13)	7	4	2	0	0	0
Remote work and communication expectations (Q4; n=13)	8	3	2	0	0	0
Workplace safety topics (Q5; n=13)	6	5	2	0	0	0
Core values (Q6)	10	4	0	0	0	0
Access to systems and tools (Q7)	14	0	1	0	0	0
Who to contact for support (Q8)	13	1	0	0	0	0
Appropriately directed questions (Q9)	13	1	0	0	0	0
Overall preparedness (Q10)	12	2	0	0	0	0

G.2 Binary and Conditional Items

Question 11a-11b: Did you need to spend time teaching new hires foundational information before you could begin role-specific training? If yes, what topics or areas required additional time?

Respondent	Response	Topics requiring additional time
M1	Yes	New hires with less business experience need more information about how organizations are structured and where to go for what.
M2	No	—
M3	No	—
M4	Yes	She needed information about how some of the policies applied to her in her role. Some of the general policies are more relevant to us in IT than others are.
M5	No	—
M6	Yes	The safety aspects are very important in the warehouse. We go over specific scenarios and additional compliance policies/

M7	No	—
M8	Yes	Some new hires have less experience working in an organization, so all of the policies are new to them. If this is the case, we have to provide more examples and explain the policies in more detail.
M9	No	—
M10	No	—
M11	No	—
M12	No	—
M13	No	—
M14	No	—

G.3 Open-ended Responses

Question 12: Is there anything else you would like to share about the readiness of new hires following the onboarding program?

Respondent	Response
M1	NEO is useful to get all new-hires through some important content.
M2	NEO just scratches the surface of the systems and processes in [our department]. We have to have our own program to get them up to speed. It would be nice if NEO provided some additional job-specific training.
M3	[Our team doesn't need] the remote working practices. We have a lot of safety and compliance policies that new-hires need to learn, and it's hard to make sure they are reading them without having them on the LMS so that my teams are accountable.
M4	It's great to have an orientation to help new employees get started.
M5	NEO is a great start for our new employees. I wish it went into more depth on the systems that we use in marketing and how we interact with customers. Thank you for everything you do!
M6	NEO provides great foundational information. Sometimes we have to review policies because they don't always remember everything they learn in orientation, but it's a nice start.
M7	No
M8	Overall, it's a good start to feel like they're part of the Tamrack family.

M9	They are ready to jump in when they're finished!
M10	—
M11	We do most of our own onboarding [redacted].
M12	NEO does a good job giving new employees an overview of the company. I wish we could do some of our more specialized safety and compliance training through the LMS.
M13	My new hire was ready to get started!
M14	They are ready to learn more.

Appendix H. Interview Summary Excerpts

H.1 Manager Interview Excerpts

Theme	Code	Quote
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	My employee had some questions about benefits, and I had to refer her to HR.
Role Readiness	Access	Mainly process details—for example, how leads are assigned and how to log sales activities. I don't think this part is covered in NEO. That's on us currently.
Role Readiness	Access	The main gap was in product knowledge and how our sales systems work. She... wasn't confident using the CRM system or discussing specific product features yet. This type of training is typically done by me and/or the team lead during the first couple of weeks of employment.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	She worked with her team lead when she had questions.
Role Readiness		...we hire people for their communication skills, so we expect everyone on the team to be a good communicator. I didn't notice any issues then or now.
Feeling Welcome	Belonging	Team based discussions during orientation might help start the team collaboration.
Role Readiness	Access	In [our department], we use tools that the rest of the company doesn't need. Our [employees] need to start using them right away.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	My new hire seemed fairly prepared in terms of understanding company policies and general expectations. She knew where to find basic information and who to contact for help, which made the first week smoother.
Role Readiness	Mentoring	I didn't get a lot of feedback from the mentor, but I appreciate the program... the mentor met with her weekly or bi-weekly and provided practical advice about working with clients and using internal tools. It made the transition easier.

Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	Overall, I think the program is solid. A little more coordination between HR and departments would make it even stronger.
Role Readiness	Access	Things like how to request IT support or navigate the internal directory. These are small but important details that slow people down in the beginning.
Program Elements	Mentoring	One mentor told me that during the first few weeks of employment, the new hire tended to ask questions mostly about job tasks, which are best directed to me or one of our team members.
Role Readiness	Access	I hate to give our own program a 4, but while the general onboarding is good, it doesn't touch much on department-specific systems. Our teams need to know HRIS and reporting tools for their work.
Role Readiness	Access	They also need to know HRIS... We spend some time each week with job-specific onboarding for at least the first month or so.
Role Readiness	Access	[Our department] is very compliance-focused, so we have a lot of policies and procedures that our new-hires need to know. They also need to know them well enough to explain them to other employees, so we have a lot of additional training to do.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	We provide a list of specific contacts as part of our job-specific onboarding, and this helps a lot.
Role Readiness		It was fine. I didn't notice any problems.
Program Elements	Mentoring	Mentors are great in supporting other aspects of their job, but a more structured approach would help ensure consistent support.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	I'd provide supervisors with a short checklist or guide to align expectations after onboarding. That way we can reinforce key points without repeating everything.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	NEO sets a good foundation, but the follow-up after the first week could be stronger. A 30-day check-in might help catch any gaps early.
Suggestions for Change	Feeling Welcome	New employees would benefit from hearing directly from senior leaders about the company's values and long-term goals more frequently than just one time

		during the orientation.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	My employee had some questions about benefits, and I had to refer her to HR.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	The compliance training needs to be more hands-on and practical. We have to review all of it here and provide examples so employees understand how important it is to our work handling chemicals and keeping the workplace safe.
Role Readiness	Access	We have to do all of our own job training here, so NEO gets them ready to start working with us.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	New hires paired with experienced workers for the first couple of months.
Role Readiness	Access	No. Most of our work is specific to the location where we work, so we don't expect any more from orientation.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	She worked with her team lead when she had questions.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	Sometimes they forget where to go for what, but we can help with that when they need something specific.
Role Readiness	Access	No, not really.
Role Readiness	Access	We have to do a lot of training on the job and it takes a lot of our time.
Feeling Welcome	Belonging	We're a close-knit team. Everyone works really well together.

H.2 Participant Interview Excerpts

Theme	Code	Quote
Feeling Welcome	Social connection	My manager and team members stopped by my desk to introduce themselves, and my mentor took me to lunch too. That helped me feel comfortable right away.
Program Elements	Self-guided training	The eLearning modules were fine but a little repetitive.
Feeling Welcome	Belonging	I thought it was a good orientation to our culture and values.
Feeling Welcome	Social connection	Having the team meetings the first week was really good, too. It let me know how the company values our teamwork.
Program Elements	Mentoring	I met with my mentor weekly for the first month and still check in occasionally. She's been very supportive and knowledgeable.
Feeling Welcome	Social connection	During the first meeting, my manager was very welcoming. He suggested I schedule an informal meeting with each team member in the next week or so. This helped me get to know everyone individually and feel comfortable working with them.
Program Elements	Cognitive overload	The only issue was finding time to complete all the eLearning while adjusting to my new workload. The eLearning modules were fine, but a little repetitive.
Program Elements	Self-guided training	I don't remember much about what was in the modules, but I remember thinking that it showed me what Tamrack thought was important for me to know and how I might be expected to interact with others here.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	I felt well prepared to start. I understood the key policies and where to find resources when I needed them.

Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	The mentor program was interesting and helpful because it gave me a chance to ask questions in a relaxed way. When the team introduced themselves, they told me a little about their responsibilities, so I knew who handled what. If I had other questions, I went to my manager.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	Maybe shorten the eLearning modules or make them more interactive.
Feeling Welcome	Social connection	I did feel welcomed — the orientation group was friendly, and my manager checked in a few times. But I didn't get to meet many people outside my immediate team.
Program Elements	Company information	The orientation session was the most helpful because it explained the company structure.
Program Elements	Mentoring	The mentor program didn't feel very active — we only met once.
Program Elements	Mentoring	My mentor was nice but busy. I wish we'd had more structured time to connect.
Feeling Welcome	Disconnection	The manager was also really busy—some issue with a big client—but he still made time to meet with me.
Program Elements	Self-guided training	The eLearning system was a bit confusing at first, and some parts in one module didn't load properly and had to contact IT.
Role Readiness	Observe real work	I felt somewhat prepared. I knew the company background but needed more guidance on sales processes and systems.
Role Readiness	Work with others	My manager asked me to shadow a more senior sales rep, so I turned to her when I needed help. She was very patient and showed me where to find things in our systems and answered a lot of the questions that I had.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	I'd add department-specific sessions or hands-on practice using our tools. It was fine overall, but the first few weeks felt a bit overwhelming with all of the systems to learn.

Program Elements	Need applied scenarios	It was okay. Informative, but a little too general for someone in a technical role.
Feeling Welcome	Disconnection	My team was very welcoming, but the orientation itself felt a bit impersonal. Most of it focused on corporate policies rather than day-to-day work.
Feeling Welcome	Disconnection	My manager and team were fine. They were impatient for me to finish orientation and get started. We were really short-handed then!
Program Elements	Self-guided training	The eLearning modules were useful for compliance topics, but the other stuff was really general and not very useful.
Program Elements	Need applied scenarios	Honestly, I didn't feel completely prepared. I understood the company culture but needed more hands-on technical orientation and system navigation.
Role Readiness	Lack of context	My team was the biggest help with that. There was not very much that was organized after orientation, so I had to figure out a lot of it on my own.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	I'd create department-specific NEO tracks, especially for the technical teams, so content feels more relevant. Also, more job-specific training. I think onboarding could better bridge the gap between general company info and actual job responsibilities.
Feeling Welcome	Belonging	I felt welcomed enough. I guess all companies have to give you a lot of information when you start.
Feeling Welcome	Belonging	There was some information about this in the orientation. I joined the company because a friend of mine works here and says it was a good place to work.
Feeling Welcome	Social connection	Everyone was really nice. Because we're on-site, my manager and team took me to lunch that day. It was a good time.
Program Elements	Mentoring	My mentor was nice, too. He checked in with me that first week to let me know I could ask him questions.

Role Readiness	Lack of context	Some of the content didn't seem very relevant to my work.
Program Elements	Need applied scenarios	I would rather learn some of this stuff on the job. The online courses were fine, but very general. I knew there was a lot more to learn. I work in the warehouse—I don't like sitting all day in front of a computer.
Role Readiness	OTJ training	I was really ready to get started and learn what I had to do on the job.
Role Readiness	Knowing who to ask	I went to my manager if I had questions. I also had a team member who worked closely with me at first to make sure I knew the ropes.
Suggestions for Change	Role Readiness	Some of the information didn't seem very relevant to our work in the distribution center, so I just had to live through it. Maybe let us start working with our teams right away and then take the stuff we need the most? I had a LOT of compliance training to take about handling hazardous chemicals, so some of that the first week would have been useful.

Appendix I. Qualitative themes by Respondent and Dimension (All Sources)

Respondent	Theme	Source	Positive	Neutral	Negative	Total
Manager	Feeling Welcomed	Interview	1	1	0	2
		Combined	1	1	0	2
Manager	Role Readiness	Interview	2	16	4	22
		Survey	7	2	2	11
		Combined	9	18	6	33
Manager Total			10	19	6	35
Participant	Feeling Welcomed	Interview	6	4	1	11
		Survey	3	10	8	21
		Combined	9	14	9	32
Participant	Role Readiness	Interview	5	1	2	8
		Survey	3	4	3	10
		Combined	8	5	5	18
Participant Total			17	19	14	50
Grand Total			27	38	20	85

Appendix J. Employee Role Readiness Survey Summary

Respondent	Item	n	Mean	% Agree (4–5)	% Neutral (3)	% Disagree (1–2)
Manager	Directed questions	14	4.93	100	0	0
Manager	Policies	13	4.38	84.6	15.4	0
Participant		27	4.52	96.3	3.7	0
Manager	Ready for role	14	4.86	100	0	0
Participant		27	4.44	100	0	0
Manager	Remote work	13	4.46	84.6	15.4	0
Participant		26	4.5	96.2	3.8	0
Participant	Self-paced modules	27	3.63	77.8	0	22.2
Manager	Systems access	14	4.86	92.9	7.1	0
Participant		27	4.96	100	0	0
Participant	Who to contact	27	4.48	100	0	0
Manager		14	4.93	100	0	0
Manager	Workplace safety	13	4.31	84.6	15.4	0
Participant		27	4.41	96.3	3.7	0